2022 Edition

APG

ACCESSING PERSONAL GENIUS

Meta-States® Certification Training

L. Michael Hall, Ph.D.

2022

APG — Accessing Personal Genius — 2022 Edition

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Meta-States Training is designed to provide information and skill-development for competence in handling meta-level phenomena. Meta-States is a model of self-reflexive consciousness within the field of Neuro-Semantics.® Meta-States Certification is valid only by a Licensed Neuro-Semantic Trainer under the auspices of the ISNS which you can find on the website under Trainers.

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Disclaimer:
This Training Manual is designed for *training and education* in the Meta-States Model. Immediate applications are in communication, self-development, and interpersonal skills. It is not and should not be used as a substitute for psychotherapy. Although I (LMH) am a psychologist and a Professional Licensed Counselor (LPC) in the State of Colorado, I designed and wrote this for use at in person trainings. It is not recommended as a substitute for professional psychological treatment.

Recordings:
For video and audio CD products, contact Tom Welch. Twelch@nlp-video.com
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This manual serves as the basis for several trainings—Self-Leadership, First Module in NLP Master Practitioner, Coaching Genius (Module II of Meta-Coaching), Required for the Self-Actualization Diploma, etc.

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PREREQUISITES OF PERSONAL GENIUS

- What are the characteristics of mastery or expertise (what we call genius)?
- How does one go about accessing and developing these prerequisites of genius?

As you begin to develop your own *personal genius* in a given area, this training is designed to enable you to *meta-state yourself with the qualities and prerequisites of personal genius.* Because there is a structure to the mastery of expertise, working with that structure, you can use it to access, amplify, and apply the variables that make up the flow state for you.

The Prerequisites of Genius in NLP
The search for these variables began with the work *Turtles All the Way Down* (1987) by Grinder and DeLozier and continued with the series *Strategies of Genius* by Robert Dilts. They discovered that among the *prerequisites of genius* are the following: n

- Intense focus or concentration — what we today call a state of flow.
- Single tracking (first-level attention).
- The multiple perspectives of "wisdom" (seeing the whole).
- A commitment state.
- Clean state accessing or making an "impeccable state shift."
- Clarity of purpose and direction

Yet *personal genius* is not just stacking lots of variables, it uses the logical levels of our mind to create an engagement matrix. This involves—

- Setting an executive level commission so you can get lost in your genius state.
- *The ability to make highly refined distinctions* within and about the qualities of the sensory representation systems while simultaneously setting empowering frames. This two-fold focus creates a meta-detailing of the genius or flow state.
- Flexibly shifting between similarity and differences.
- A *playfully passionate learning state* which accelerates your learning and creativity.
- A *clear vision* that works as a self-organizing attractor.
- A disciplined perseverance to keep at your passion to actualize it.
- A *proactive responsiveness* to take the initiate, learn from mistakes, and take on challenges.
- To *openly receive feedback* for testing, exploring, experimenting as you implement.
- Being *aligned* within yourself for focus and congruency.
- Being connected to others as collaborators and colleagues, etc.
- Being *decisive* as you step up to *choice points* and make life-enhancing decisions.
- The state management skills to step in and out of states of flow at will.
- The *resilience* to bounce back from every setback.

A genius or flow state is an optimal state that is challenging, inspiring, highly meaningful that requires certain level of competency or skill in performance of it.

WELCOME TO THE MAGIC OF THE META-LEVELS

This manual is designed to facilitate training and re-training of your brain and nervous systems so that you can work more methodically with your mind *at all its levels*. Then you can achieve the kind of *states of excellence* that will enrich your life and create a high quality of personal mastery. There are two primary objectives in this training:

1) *Introduce the Meta-States model.*

To acquaint you with a methodical model of how your mind works, the levels of your mind, and the matrix of beliefs and frames that governs your everyday experiences, your outer games.

2) *Facilitate your own Personal Genius* or Expertise.

NLP gives you a User's Manual for the Brain. Neuro-Semantics continues that adventure giving you access to the higher levels of your mind—to your executive functions.

Warning: *To Learn the Meta-States Model involves a different kind of thinking.*

- It is not the linear thinking of cause-effect or of the Strategy model.
- It involves systemic, non-linear thinking. It means going in circles, looping around an idea, simultaneously holding on to several ideas, working with the whole mind-body-emotion system.
- This means you may experience confusion and bewilderment. So get ready to embrace the unknown and the complex. As your mind is recursive, get ready for a spin and enjoy the ride!
- Learning *Meta-States* involves discovering how to think systemically, how to track a spiral of thought around loops, and to manage the matrix of frames occurring simultaneously.

Solution:

- Lighten up and play with your self-reflexive consciousness! Allow yourself to get lost at times, to feel confused, to become disoriented. It's part of how you'll discovery the magic of the meta-levels. You will come out on the other side more empowered and resourceful than you have ever before.

WHY DEVELOP YOUR META-SKILLS?

There are many reasons to develop a meta-states and the meta-level understandings and skills. Because you have a *self-reflective consciousness*, you inevitably "go meta" to your thoughts, feelings, states, and experiences. It is built in. In this way, you *layer* thoughts upon thoughts. You *embed* states upon states. As you now learn to recognize this and unpack this layering, there are many values and benefits.

- Understanding more about yourself and how your mind works.
- Understanding others more compassionately.
- Comprehending the multiple motivations that we all have about things.
- Avoiding the *meta-muddles* so can so quickly arise.
- Learning state management of your thoughts and emotions (E.Q.).

- Identifying the hidden frames that drive your motivations.
- Understanding how the higher levels of beliefs, values, decisions, identity, intention, memory, imagination, etc. work together to create our internal "model of the world."
- Recognizing the internal *contexts* that people operate from.
- Modeling complex states like courage, resilience, forgiveness, etc.
- Discovering the "crazy" logic of our "psycho-logics" (Korzybski).
- Developing high quality communication skills and especially meta-communicative skills.
- Mastering conceptual states to create a good relationship with ideas.
- Discovering the structure of the state of flow in order to turn it on and off at will.
- Expanding perspective for greater wisdom.
- Setting enhanced frames at higher levels and higher quality states.
- Thinking systemically for more personal choice.
- Aligning all of the levels of mind for the personal power of congruency.
- Resolving internal conflicts between opposing frames.
- Relating to others with more elegance and grace.
- Discovering the structure for wealth-creation for financial independence.
- Influencing, persuading, and selling more effectively and ethically.
- Staying healthy and fit with energy and vitality.
- Enjoying more loving relationships.
- Resolving conflicts with grace and dignity
- Etc.

YOUR OUTCOMES FOR THIS TRAINING

What are your key personal outcomes for this training?
What do you absolutely want to accomplish by the end of this training?
State your objectives in specific terms so that you can check off those that you reach at the end of the training.

1. _____
_____
_____

2. _____
_____
_____

3. _____
_____
_____

Day 1

WELCOME TO

THE MATRIX OF YOUR MIND

Day 1 Menu:

Introduction to States and Meta-States

1) Meta-Stating Ownership for your powers

2) Meta-Stating Self for Self-Acceptance, Self-Appreciation and Self-Esteem

3) Meta-Stating Confirmation and Dis-confirmation for commissioning and decommissioning beliefs.

4) Meta-Stating Pleasure: Meta-Pleasuring and De-Pleasuring

STATES

To understand meta-states, you have to understand states.

- A *"state"— a mental and emotional state;* a dynamic mind-body state of experience or being; an experiential energy field. *State— state* of mind*, state* of body, and *state* of emotion which are inter-related and inseparable. We can only separate these linguistically as a description. *As* we think, *so* we feel in our body and move and act and this entire configuration (gestalt) which we then "experience." We live and move and have our being as mind-body persons—as *a neuro-linguistic class of life.*

- As a neuro-linguistic class of life we *experience and map* the territory beyond our skin, the world "out there" to effectively relate to it. Most fundamentally we are pattern detectors and mappers. As we map, so we become. It begins with our *neurology*—how our nervous systems and sense receptors, then our *linguistics* (symbols, words, metaphors, classifications) create our programs.

- In this way we can take charge and *run our own brains.* Take charge of your "reality constructions" empowers you to become the architect of your future. As you build more accurate and enhancing models of the world, you increase your resourcefulness.

Our Mind-Body Components of States

Given that we *create* states from how we map things mentally and emotionally, we have *two royal roads* to state. Two avenues that we can use to evoke a state:

1) Mind—> Linguistics:

Internal representations specify your state of mind—the things that you internally map things visually, auditorially, and kinesthetically as well as the things that you say to yourself (language), your understandings, learnings, beliefs, values, etc. that make up the representations on "the theater of the mind." Choice about what to represent and how to encode gives you *representational power*. In Neuro-Semantics we call the result, the representational screen or internal cinema or movie of the mind (see *MovieMind*, 2003).

The sensory representation systems or VAK:

Visual: pictures, scenes, images
Auditory: sounds, noises, music
Kinesthetic: sensations, touches, tactile, proprioceptive, motor movements
Olfactory (smell), Gustatory (taste), and Vestibular (balance)

The language representation system (auditory-digital)

Words, Sentences, Linguistic structures
Mathematics, Music symbols, Metaphors, Stories, Symbols

2) Body —> Neurology:

Physiology and/or Neurology describes the physical state or state of "body"—the things that you experience in your body involving health, posture, breathing, bio-chemistry, etc. The functioning of your nervous systems as they interact within your body and physiology of your central, peripheral, and autonomic nervous systems.

STATE MANAGEMENT #101

If you do not managing your state,
someone or something else will!

State Object:

In primary states (i.e., fear, anger, joy, calmness, sadness, etc.) the **object** usually refers to something *outside* you and "beyond" your nervous system..
What do your thoughts-and-feelings refer to? What's on your mind?

State Awareness:

Awareness of the states and their factors. All states *habituate* and so drop out of conscious awareness. Notice the quality of the state: How "pure" your state? How much congruity? Complexity or simplicity? Meaning or semantics? Pain-pleasure quality? How is the state *encoded and structured?* Identify the qualities, properties, features, distinctions in the representations governing its intensity (i.e. vivid, sharp, quick, degree of movement, etc.).

State Assessing/ Inducing:

Memory: *Remembering a state.* "Recall a time when . . ."
Imagination: *Creating a state*. "What would it look, sound, and feel like if . . ."
Modeling: *Observing a state.* "Who do you know that experiences X?"

State Altering:

States do not stay the same, they are forever changing. Count on your states altering, shifting, and transforming. What methods do you have for *altering* your states?

State Intensity and Amplification:

Gauge each state in terms of intensity. How much do you experience the state? What level of strength or weakness does the state convey? How much does it dominate your consciousness? Do you meed more? Increase or intensify the representations to experience more of the state. All states do not have the same level of intensity, so gauge for intensity level. Do you need more "juice?" What processes do you rely on for amplifying your states? How do you crank them up?

State Interrupts:

You can stop a mind-body-emotion state via jarring, interfering, sabotaging, preventing, etc. When a state is overly intense and dysfunctional in its effects, a s*tate interrupt* enables you to stop or prevent the state from doing damage as you break the state.

State Dependency:

States govern learning, memory, perception, behavior, communication, etc. (state-dependent LMPBC). State dependency are "emotional expectation sets" or "conceptual expectation sets" and determine what you see and hear.

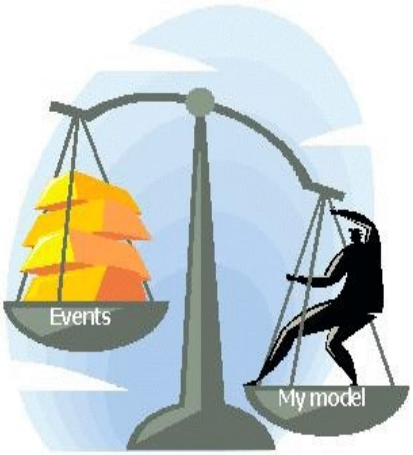
State Contrasts:

Compare one state with another to gain insightful understanding about "the difference that makes a difference." What explains the difference? Does it occur at a primary or meta-level? All states are not the same. State configurations come in all sizes and shapes. Just because you have accessed a state of thoughts-and-emotions and physiology, you may not access a similar state to someone else doing the same.

State Anchoring:

Set up a trigger (sight, sound, sensation, movement, gesture, word, etc.) and link it to the state. *Anchors* operate as Pavlovian conditioning tools for state management and depend on uniqueness, intensity, timing, and purity. Wait until you or another person reaches the *peak* of the experience, then link some *unique trigger* to it. Test to see if the *trigger* then "fires off" the state. If so, you have an "anchor."

Emotions and States:



An emotion is a combination of sensations (kinesthetics) and language as evaluations. It is a meta-level structure. Within "emotions" are *evaluative judgments, beliefs, meanings, values, etc.*

As states, your emotions register your body's (soma) sense of the meaning or evaluation and so helps you feel the energy of the meaning. Emotions are the evaluative difference between your *model of the world* (wants, expectations, demands, understandings, etc.) and your *experience of the world.* The difference between the two is your *emotion*.

The *primary* emotions already operate as a meta-level phenomena. Technically we could *tease out* yet another *lost level* (or coalesced level) inside the primary state: a set of kinesthetic sensations plus a cognitive evaluative judgment of meaning. Inasmuch as the primary emotions already involve cognitive evaluations from a previous meta-level having *coalesced* into a primary state, we have this as an illustration of how meta-levels do merge with primary states.

State Extending / State Containment

We can both *extend* and *contain* states—these properties of neuro-linguistic states enable us to take the thoughts-feelings and all of the mind-body correlations and contaminate other experiences with a state. We can also build boundaries and barriers around a state so as to disconnected to other things. In various contexts, both phenomena provide new resources if used appropriately.

States have expressions and frames

Expressions of state (thinking-feeling, speaking, behaving) direct our awareness to our body and the outside world as we become aware of what we feel and want to do or say.

T — What do you think about this or that?
F — What do you feel?
S — What do you say?
B — What do you do?

Frame is the significance or meaning—the cognitive structure of the state that actually creates the state. With the four expressions you build up and format an infinite number of frames as you give meaning to whatever you are experiencing. These then govern the state. You can use these facets to set frames as reference structures for time, history, beliefs, values, self, concepts, and all of the meta-levels (see the meta-questions).

META-STATES

States about States

Reflexive States
Something wild and wonderful happens when we access and relate one state to other states—you create a meta-state. In these complex states, your self-reflexive consciousness relates (not to the world), but to yourself, to your thoughts, feelings,, or to some abstract conceptual state. You access a state of thoughts-feelings and *apply it to another state*. You layer state upon state: you feel upset about your anger; joyful *about* freedom; anger *at* your fear.

Higher States
The *object* of the state changes from an outside/external object to an internal, conceptual, and semantic object. You now think-and-feel about previous thoughts-and-feelings. The state in a higher position is *meta* (above, beyond) to the second and so operates as a higher *logical level*.

Psycho-logical States
The "crazy" internal logic that arises from the layering of states, namely, our *psycho-logics.* When you *transcend* from one state (say, anger or joy) to another state (say, calmness or respect) you set the second state as a frame over the first and *include* it inside it. This creates "calm anger," respectful joy, joyful learning, etc. It makes the first state a member of the class of the second.

Psycho-Logical. If you say, "But that's not logical." Yes, you're right. It is not. Yet it is *psycho–logical.* That's the difference. On the inside, when you put a state like anger or fear inside another state (calmness, respect, gentleness, courage, etc.), you change the internal logic. This is what we mean when we talk about "logical levels." When you put one state in a "logical" relationship to another state so that one is at a higher *level* then the higher one is *about* the other. This *about-relationship* establishes the "logic."

Meta- or Logical-Level States;
Logical levels are not "things." They do not exist "out there." They exist only in the mind as how a person represents categories as one categorizes and layers a level of thought upon level of thought and emotion. *Logical level* is comprised of two nominalizations. So what's the hidden verbs in those false-nouns? Layering and reasoning—the reasoning that you layer over your previous experiences.

States — made out of fluid Logical Levels
To understand Meta-States, you have to shift from thinking about rigid hierarchical levels to *fluid levels* ever in flux, ever moving, changing, and in process. They are not "things," they are not rigid, as mental and emotional energy expressions of representing and framing they arise and vanish according to our thinking. That's why they are so fluid and plastic and do not hold still.

- The levels (or layering) are made out of *the stuff* of state (thoughts-and-feelings). They are not "real" or solid or static even though we use nominalizations like beliefs, values, identity, mission, understanding, intentions, etc. to describe them.
- In Meta-States we have identified over *104 logical levels*. From these meta-levels we have a set of Meta-Questions: decisions, understandings, expectations, knowledge, pleasure, intention, symbols, metaphors, etc.
- Amazingly, each of these terms are *facets of the same thing—the single experience* or state. The different words are just different facets. If you bring a state of confidence to your self, this operates as a *belief*, and because you treat this as important, you *value* it; you *understand* facets of some *knowledge* that area, this leads to *expectations, decisions*, *identifications, intentions,* etc.

Four Essential Meaning Dimensions

When you meta-state, as you set frames you simultaneously create meaning. These become your internal contexts and categories of your meaning matrix. "Meaning" is what you "hold in mind" and there are four most foundational meanings that we all need in order to function.

1) What is it?
How representation?
How identify? Label? Classify?

2) How does it work?
Causation: what causes what?
What variable influences what?

3) What is its significance?
What does it mean?
What is its value? Importance?

4) What is the intention?
What is your purpose, design?
What are you trying to achieve?

Dimensions of Meaning

1) ***Emotional meaning****: Associating*

2) ***Survival meaning****: Evaluating*

3)***Metaphorical meaning****: Metaphoring*

4)***Representative meaning****: representing*

5) ***Editorial meaning****: Editorial framing*

6) ***Linguistic meaning****: Languaging*

7) ***Conceptual meaning****:*

8) ***Perceptual meaning:*** *Thinking patterns*

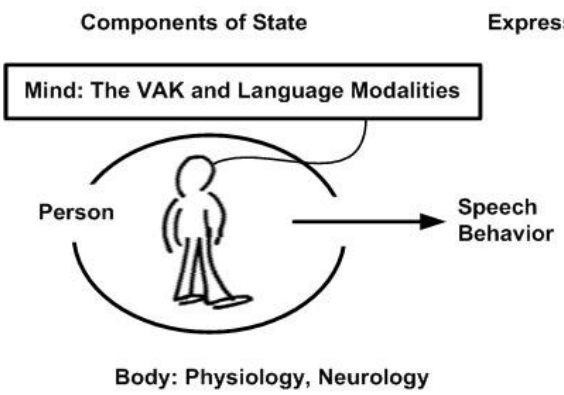
9) ***Intentional meaning****: Intentions*

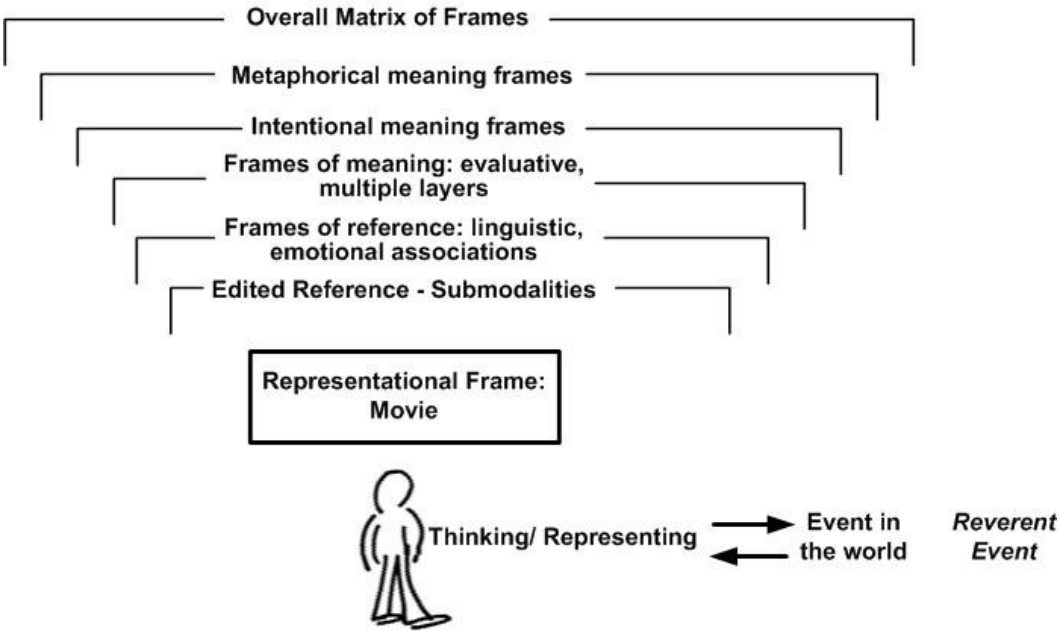
Given our meta-levels of states upon states —

IT IS BELIEFS OR FRAMES ALL THE WAY UP

Model of the world
Frames-of-References
Identifications (identifying with thoughts about rep.)
Paradigms
Understanding
Decisions (choosing Thoughts about Thoughts)
Valuing (thoughts of importance about thoughts)

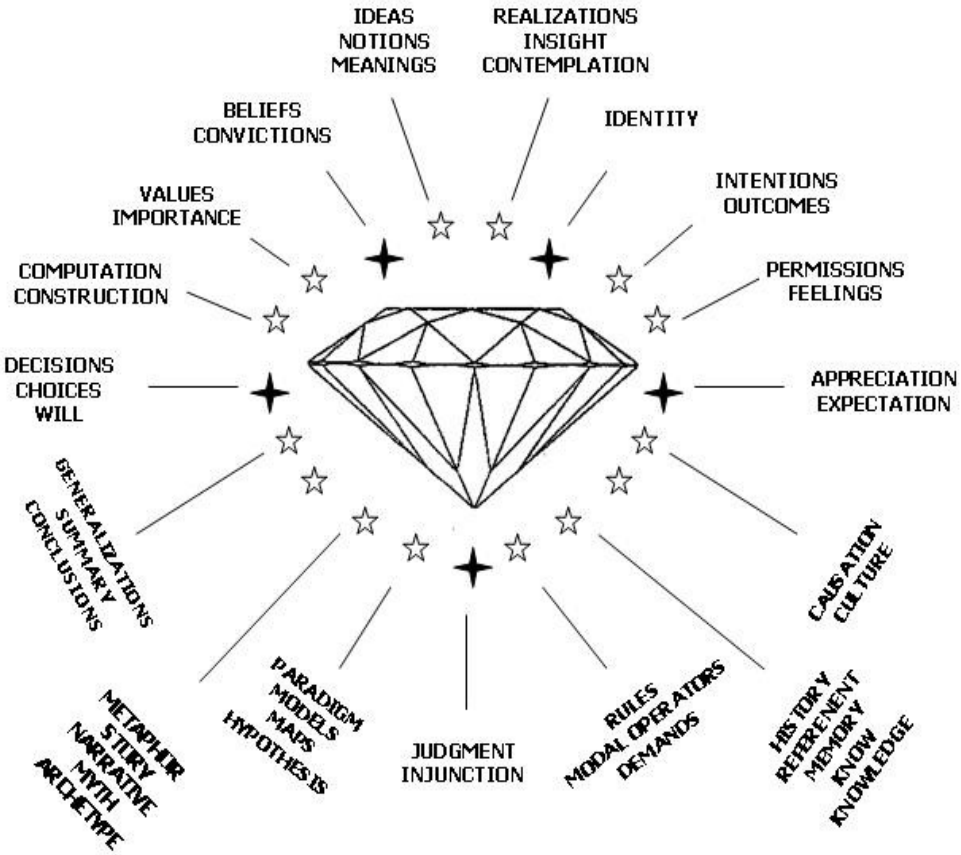
B e l i e v i n g (confirmed thoughts about thoughts)





DIAMOND OF CONSCIOUSNESS

The Many Meta-Facets of Awareness



META-QUESTIONS
FOR TEASING OUT META-STRUCTURES

Of all states, *your meta-states are the most important states.* Do you know why this is so and the reason for it? Precisely because meta-states, as *higher* states, govern, modify, modulate, control, drive, and organize our everyday primary states. In other words, because meta-messages modify lower-level messages (Gregory Bateson, 1972).

The *fluid levels* of meta-states are ever in flux, ever moving, changing, and in process. They are not things, they are not rigid, as mental and emotional energy expressions of representing and framing they arise and vanish according to our thinking and re-thinking. That's why they are so fluid and plastic.

Each of the meta-terms describe aspects of your mind's logical levels. If you bring a state of confidence to your self, this operates as a *belief*, and because you treat this as important, you *value* it; you *understand* facets of some *knowledge* of that area which leads to *expectations, decisions*, *identifications, intentions,* etc. Each term simultaneously has within it all of the other terms so that each level can be viewed from a multitude of perspectives or facets. That's why we call the "logical levels" a *diamond of consciousness*—each offers a multi-facetic perspective.

Think of the following as more than 100 ways to move around the *diamond of consciousness* and see, hear, feel and explore the many *facets* of perception and focus. These *facets of focus* give you multiple ways into the matrix of a mind. So if you use one word or term and it doesn't elicit more information, use another. When we coach to the matrix, we use many questions in each of these categories.

The basic 15 Meta-Questions:

1. Meaning / Significance Ideas that we hold in mind.	What does this mean to you? What meanings are you holding in mind?
2. Belief / Believe / Confirm as real Ideas we affirm, validate, and confirm.	What do you believe about this? What do you believe about that belief?
3. Frame / Reference Ideas we set as our frame of reference and mental contexts.	What is your frame of mind about this? What's your frame of reference for this? How are you framing this experience?
4. *Permission / Allow / Permit / Embrace / Approve* Ideas about allowance and permission versus ideas about prohibitions and taboos.	Do you have permission to experience this? Who took permission away from you? Are you ready to allow this for yourself?
5. Prohibition / Taboo / Censor / Dis-allow Ideas we do not allow and permit but prohibit and taboo.	Is this experience or idea prohibited in you? Would it enhance your experience to taboo this? Who has tabooed this for you?
6. Feeling (any feeling: love, hate, care, joy, etc.) Emotional ideas and feeling judgments we bring to other ideas.	What do you feel about this? What if you could enjoy this? What feeling would enhance this most?

7. Thought / Notion / Idea / Word Ideas or thoughts that we bring to some previous idea or thought.	What do you think about this? What thoughts come to mind regarding this? What's your notion about this?
8. Appreciate / Appreciation / Celebrate Ideas of appreciation or value used to frame other ideas.	What do you appreciate most about this? What could you appreciate about this? Do you appreciate this too much?
9. Value / Importance / Count / Honor Ideas we value and treat as important or significant, which we esteem.	What do you value about this? What's important about this that you can count? Do you honor this in yourself or others?
10. Decision / Choice / Will / Pros and Cons Ideas we "cut off" (cision) from other ideas as choices we say *Yes* and *No* to.	What's your decision about this? What choice would you like to make about this? What pros and cons are you weighing?
11. Intention / Want / Desire Ideas about motives, intentions, desire, and wants.	What's your highest intention about this? What do you want and really desire about this? What intention is driving your response?
12. Outcome / Goal / Agenda/ Hidden Agenda Ideas we have about goals, outcomes, and desired ends.	What outcome do you have about this? What goal do you have beyond this goal? What's your higher agenda behind this?
13. Expectation / Anticipation Ideas we have about what we anticipate will happen	What's your expectation about this? What do you anticipate will happen about this? What do you expect about this idea?
14. Rules / Demand / Should / Must / Shall / Authorize / Injunctions / Policy Ideas we use as rules for the games we play in our lives, modal operators that generate our *modus operandi* (MO).	What *should* you do about this? What do you *have to* do regarding this? Why? What is the rule that's governing your thoughts? Who or what authorizes this policy for you? What injunctions are you acting out?
15. *Definition / Class / Categorize / Category Define / Label* Ideas we have that set the categories in our mind for understanding things.	What definition do you use in relating to this? What class do you put this into? How do you categorize this? What other definition could you use for this?

THE BASIC META-STATING PATTERN

The actual process of meta-stating is actually very simple—*accessing* a thought or emotion and *apply* it to another state (i.e., thought, emotion, or physiology). That's the short and quick approach. *Access and apply.*

With *accessing* is *amplifying* to get enough of the state. And within *applying* is *appropriating to life contexts and analyzing* to quality control the end result and effects. This give us a total of 5 ***steps*** **—**all when start with **A.** This **5** words that start with **A** make the basic meta-stating process easier to remember. Two more words, beginning with A extends this to *awareness* and *accelerate*.

**** Awareness**

Become aware of your state and what resource you want to apply to it.

1) Access a resource state.

What resource state do you want to *bring to bear on* or apply to the primary state?
A *"resource"* can be a thought, feeling, idea, belief, value, memory, imagination.

2) Amplify fully and anchor.

Juice up the resource state and establish an anchor for it by touch, sight, sound, word, etc.
Do you have a sufficiently strong enough state with which to work?

3) Apply *to the primary state.*

Bring the resource *to bear* on the primary state (this creates meta-level anchoring), or embed the primary state inside a resource state.

4) Appropriate *to your life, to specific contexts, or to the future (future pacing).*

Where do you want to experience this meta-state?
Imagine having this layered consciousness in your mind as your frame as you move out into your future.

5) Analyze the quality, health, balance (ecology) of the system.

Would it enhance your life to set this resource as your frame-of-reference for the primary state experience?
Would every facet of your mind-and-body align with this?

**** Accelerate**

Put it into action and accelerate your resourceful empowerment in real life!

ACCELERATING LEARNING

What *learning state* would you like? What qualities of learning would enable you to learn more quickly, thoroughly, and to integrate your learnings for everyday implementation.?

Distinctions:

- You can *qualify* the nature of your learning state by meta-stating it.
- The quality of your state is a function of the quality of your meta-states.
- Multiple meta-stating creates gestalts. A *gestalt* is something that is more than the sum of the parts. In an inter-active system such as the mind-body-emotion system, we have a context within which systemic phenomena can arise—*emergent properties* or gestalts. *Strategically think through* the effect of level-upon-level to check the ecological value of the meta-stating.

Elicitation questions:

What kind of a learning state do you want?
What's the quality of your current learning state?
Would you like to add new qualities to it?

The Pattern:

1) Dream about an accelerated learning state.

Pair up and brainstorm about how you want to refine and texture your own personal learning state.
What resourceful states do you want to apply to your basic learning state?
How do you want to sequence these states-upon-states?

2) Access and apply each resourceful state to your learning state.

What state of thought or emotion would you like to apply to your joyful learning state?
Check and see, does it make a difference?
Does it enable you to implement what you learn?

Menu List of Possibilities:

Playfulness	Frolicsome Learning	Lustful Learning
Experimenting	Calm Learning	Awesome Learning
Optimistic Learning	Outrageous Learning	Decisive Learning
Future-pacing	Confident Learning	Tenacious Learning
Implementation for integrated learning		

3) Meta-state your learning state until the desired gestalt results.

Access the resource that you want for your learning, amplify it, and then apply.
Repeat with other resources until your learning state has the qualities you desire.

TWO APG METHODOLOGIES

1) Traditional Approach: Each pattern as a stand-alone pattern.

Each pattern is presented as a complete pattern and one that can be used for multiple purposes. Each of the 14 patterns is a Coaching Pattern. You can use each for a way to "run your own brain" for a particular purpose. Most of these patterns have multiple uses and many can be used for a full day training. For example, the first pattern "Power Zone" is expanded in the full day training, *Accessing Personal Power.*

2) APG in Stages: Each pattern building up a single "genius" or flow state.

Each pattern in this approach builds on the previous pattern/s. This is known as doing the *Accessing Personal Genius in stages*—each pattern adds to the texture of the one genius state you have chosen to develop. The idea is that by picking one state of engagement and applying everything to that one state, you can then repeat that process on as many genius states as you would like to create.

Orientation for choosing a "genius" state: Possibilities for selecting an engagement state:

Reading	Composing	*Name your Sport:*
Writing	Painting	Soccer
Running	Singing	golfing
Coaching	Playing a musical instrument	Playing tennis
Training	Selling	Baseball
Listening	Customer Service	Basketball
Questioning	Parenting	Football
Receiving Feedback	Disciplining	Swimming
Giving Feedback	Delegating	
Confronting	Persuading	
Skiing	Dancing (name your dance)	
Keynoting	Conflict Resolution	
Negotiating	Problem-Solving	
Modeling	Problem-reporting	
Interviewing	Brainstorming	
Collaborating	Team Building	

Pattern #1 for APG in Stages:

1) Identify the new Genius state of Excellence that you want.

What state of excellence do you want to develop? What do you call this state?
What are you engaged in when in this state? What is your focus in this engagement?
Contexts: When, where, and with whom?

_____

_____

_____

SCHEDULE FOR APG IN STAGES

Day 1: Welcome to the Matrix of your Mind

1) Introducing Meta-States and Access a Genius or Flow State

- Modeling Self-Reflexive Consciousness

2) Meta-Stating Intentionality: Taking an Intentional Stance.

- Synthesis of *attention* and *intention* for the "will" to focus.
- Your highest intentional state for your big enough *why.*

3***) Meta-Stating Awareness and Ownership of powers***

- Awareness of your 4 basic powers: mind-emotion, speech and behavior.
- Ownership of powers for response-ability.

4) Meta-Stating Self for Self-Acceptance, Self-Appreciation and Self-Esteem

- A solid sense of Self for the self-forgetting in the genius state.

5) Meta-Stating Confirmation and Disconfirmation for Belief Change.

- How confirmation turns a "thought" into a "belief."
- Dis-conforming to dis-validate and downgrade a belief to a mere thought.
- Managing beliefs for your highest states of flow.

Day 2: Clearing the Path for Mastery Frames

1) Meta-Stating Pleasure for the Joy of the genius state.

- Access meta-pleasures for endow activities with joyful fun.
- De-Pleasuring to undo semantic damage from over-loading something with too much pleasure.

2) Meta-Stating Troubling Emotions for emotional mastery.

- Accepting, appreciating, and enabling emotions for their energy.

3) Meta-Stating Concepts: Conceptual De-Programming.

- Creating good relations with concepts that may push your buttons.

4) Dancing with Dragons: Transforming the Energy of Unresourceful States

- Undoing the damage from turning your energies against yourself.
- Taming, transforming, and slaying "dragon" states of self-sabotage.

5) Meta-Stating Implementation and closing the knowing-doing gap.

- Transferring "knowledge" into muscle memory for embodying great ideas.
- Turn the principles of your field for mastery into your *neuro*-semantic states.

Day 3: Qualifying and Texture Your Genius States

1) Meta-Stating Creative Possibilities.

- Meta-State the Miracle Question for a new kind of thinking from the problem.

2) Meta-Stating the "Flow" or Personal Genius state.

- Practice clean state shifting and setting boundaries on your genius state.

3) Meta-Stating Excuselessness— Blow-Out all Excuses.

- Becoming unstoppable by not giving in to excuses and stop selling yourself short.

4) Meta-Stating Congruence by resolving internal conflicts.

- Meta-state disorientation by *spinning icons* and creating a new equilibrium.

5) Meta-Stating Integrity.

- Align your meta-levels for personal power, efficacy, and grace.

META-STATING OWNERSHIP OF YOUR POWERS

Among your most basic states is your power to think, feel, say, and do. These are your fundamental powers as responses. They establish all of the higher and more complex powers. Begin with *awareness* to recognize and own these core abilities. Then access a sense of ownership (expressed in the word "mine!"). Do this to establish the basis for *personal empowerment, responsibility, proactivity,* and *initiative.*

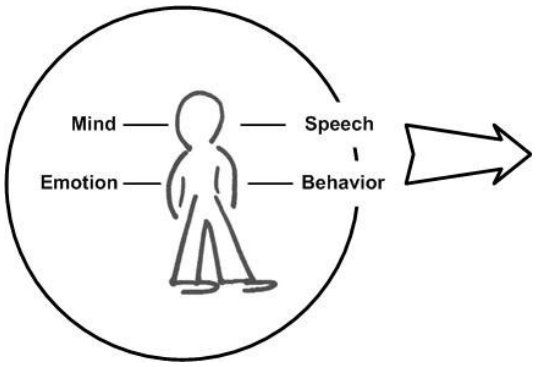
> "No one can drive me crazy
> Unless I give the keys away."
> *Colin Cox*

Distinctions:

- The power to respond to events and triggers lies in your *ability-to-respond* (responsibility).
- When you take ownership of your powers you take control of your life, that puts you at cause and at a choice point.

Elicitation Questions:

- Would you like to become completely response-able and empowered in your life?
- Would you like to eliminate the victim-attitude of feeling controlled by others?
- Are there ever times in life when you feel dis-empowered or unable to respond as you wish?



The Pattern:

1) Identify an event which invites dis-empowerment (this is used for contrastive analysis).

Have you ever felt dis-empowered? Recalling it now, what triggers that feeling?
What triggers you so you feel that you do not have the power to choose your response?
Do you ever feel that you are being controlled by an external trigger?
Identify that as a state of dis-empowerment. Set that aside for now. We will use it later.

2) Access a full experience of your four central response powers.

Have you ever felt so empowered that you controlled your power to choose your *response*?
Have you ever felt strong to choose your response and to be at your best?
Go into that state now and become aware of your personal powers. Notice how you are able to respond in the following four ways. 2 are your private responses and 2 are public responses. By these, you influence your world:
* *Thinking:* You are a thinker, you represent, believe, value, understand, reason, etc. You can make pictures and sounds inside, you can imagine, remember. You can create all kinds of mental pictures and understandings.
* *Emoting:* You are a feeler. You feel, somatize, value, care, etc. You have an immense range of emotions: love, hate, anger, joy, fear, attraction, aversion, etc.
* *Speaking:* You are a speaker. You language things, you use and manipulate symbols, asserting, etc. With words you can bless and curse, you can question and state, you can

explore and wonder, you can sell and negotiate. You can do so many things!
* *Behaving:* You are an actor. You act, respond, and relate. With actions you can stand, sit, walk, run, raise your hand and volunteer, signal hello or goodbye, play, etc.

As you bring *awareness* to these powerful responses, how does it feel?
How fully do you *feel* them? Are they strong enough to give you the sense of empowerment? If so, what do you need to do to amplify them?
What is it like for you when you use your hands to mime out these expressions of your *powers* in your own personal "space" to create a *circle of power* for yourself?

3) Access and amplify a state of ownership.

What do you completely and absolutely own? Think of something small and simple. Your toothbrush? Your hand? Your panties?
As you find something that can you say *"mine!"* to with every fiber of your being, do that and anchor the ownership state with a touch (and/or invite a self-anchor).

> [Feel it when you strongly sense that something is yours, when every fiber in your being says, *"Mine!"* Keep it small and simple: "My hand!" "My eye." "My cat." "My toothbrush." [Make sure your referent for "Mine!" is a positive one.]

As you now think about something that, let every fiber feel it fully—how is that?
How strong is your sense of *"Mine!"*? What do you need to do to increase the sense of ownership?
As you listen to your voice of *"Mine!"* what do you need to do to make this voice more compelling? Is it yours? Really?

4) Amplify your ownership state until you fully feel your ownership.

Feeling the sense of *ownership* fully, now *feel this about your mind, your emotions, your speech, and your behavior.* How well does this set the frame for your responses. Do you like that? What is it now like as you apply *ownership* to your response-powers? Say:

> "This is my *zone* of power. I am totally responsible for my *responses* of mind, emotion, speech and behavior..." Notice how that transforms things.
> How much do you feel this? Do you need to amplify and make stronger?

5) Appropriate your ownership-of-your-powers-to-respond to the dis-empowerment (#1).

Now with all of these feelings bubbling inside as a bubble of energy ... what is it like when you *feel this* about that event or situation that you thought about earlier and set aside? Be sure to bring it back now and experience it *from inside your power zone.*
Notice how this transforms your response to that. How well can you maintain your sense of your power to respond in that context now? Do you like this?

6) Future pace to install

At a rate and speed just right for you, bring back the original trigger and notice how your power zone changes that experience.
Imagine in the weeks and months to come, moving through the world with this frame of mind about your zone of response... power...
Do you like that?
As you notice how it transforms things as it allows you to fully claim you mind, heart, voice, and response powers, will you keep this?

7) [Optional] ***Distinguish responsibility to and for***
While inside your power bubble, notice how you feel when you say,

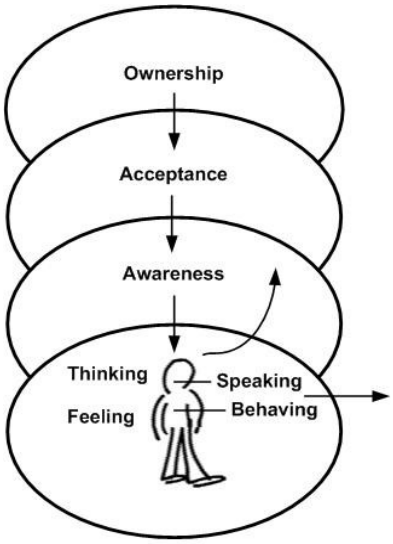
> "I am response-able **for** my thoughts, feelings, speech, and behavior. Response-ability **for** is my *Accountability."*

Notice how well this settles. How many more time do you need to say this until it settles well? Are there any objections to it in the back of your mind? Now say,

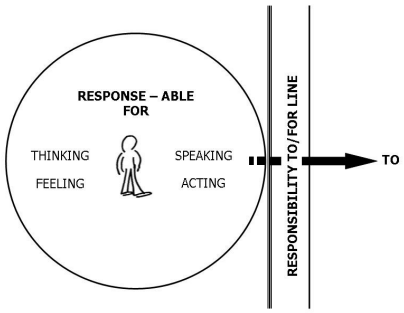
> "I am response-able **to** others but never **for** what others think, feel, say or do. Response-able **to** others is my *relationship* with others. They are responsible for how they respond, how they think, feel, speak, and act."

Notice how this settles and any objections. Now say,

> "The boundary of our Power Zone Bubble is the line between responsibility to and for . . ."



Power Zone



Using "Power Zone" for APG in Stages:
You can do the following *before* or *after* accessing your personal powers and owning them.
1) Identify your Genius State.

> What is the genius state that you are developing? What do you call it?

2) Re-Access your Intentional State.

> What is your intention behind this state? Why do this?

Pattern #2 APG in Stages

INTENTIONALITY
Meta-Stating Attractor Frames
For a Self-Organizing Neuro-Semantic System

"*Self-organization theory* is a branch of systems theory that relates to the process of order formation in complex dynamic systems. Paradoxically, it arose from the study of chaos. Scientists studying chaos (the absence of order) noticed that when enough complexly interacting elements were brought together, rather than create chaos, order seemed to 'spontaneously' form as a result of the interaction.

According to 'self-organization' theory, order in an interconnected system of elements arises around are called *'attractors'*, which help to create and hold stable patterns within the system." (Robert Dilts, *Strategies of Genius*, p. 255)

What is an Attractor?

Perceptually: a focal point in a phenomenon around which the rest of our perceptions become organized. What are the lines or shadows that organize your perceptions to see young woman? Old woman?

Conceptually: the *content* of some thought or feeling now pulls on other thoughts and feelings to support it. An idea that you value energizes and drives the neuro-semantic system.

How does an Attractor work?

It *configures* the images (representations) inside of a frame so that it *attracts* a certain way of seeing, hearing, feeling, languaging, or responding.

It structures the *foregrounding and backgrounding* of our perceptions and meta-programs.

It organizes the *computations* you use as you construct your model of the world—your beliefs. What you believe causes something (cause-effect) and what you believe something is (complex equivalence).

An attractor *magnetizes and organizes* the data so it fits the ideas, beliefs, values, etc. in the frame.

It *governs and modulates* your experiences as a kind of meta-filter and so sets up a self-fulfilling prophecy.

An attractor operates by feedback loops and governs those feedback loops.

It creates your own resonant signature for your unique style of moving through the world.

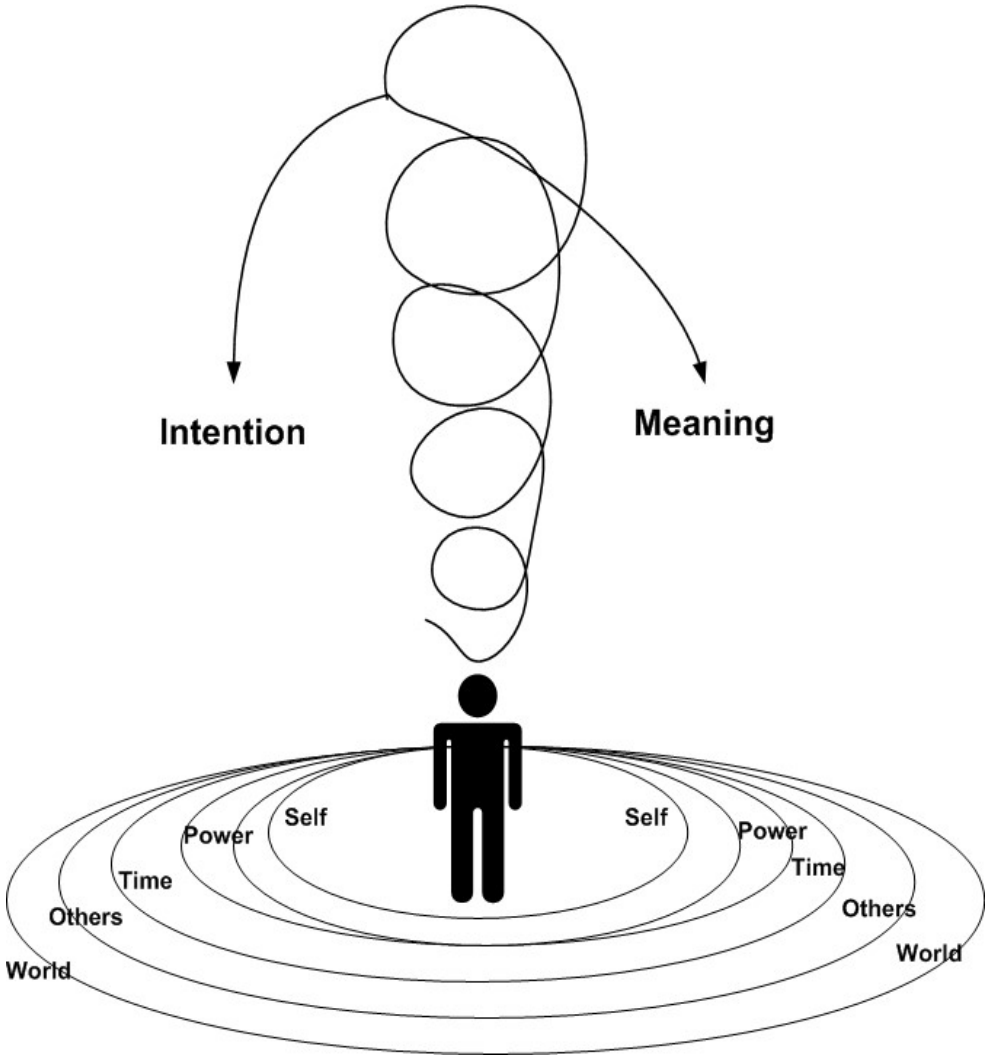
What are you Attracted To? What functions as an Attractor in Your World?

List the ideas, beliefs, understandings, values, experiences, references, etc. that tends to keep pulling on you.

What drives them? What empowers them?

Have you ever had an Attractor but it has become non-operational? What? How has it been de-commissioned? What de-stabilized the attractor? How did it become de-stabilized?

ENERGY FLOWS
WHERE ATTENTION GOES
AS DIRECTED BY INTENTION



Accessing Personal Genius #2
Setting your Genius Intentions

"He who has a why to live can bear almost any how." Nietzsche

You know the genius state that you want to access, develop, enrich, and install, so now is time to bring your intentions to that state.

Elicitation Questions:

- Do you have enough intentionally in your genius state to attract and align your attentions so that you are completely present?
- Do you need to endow your genius state with more significance and value?

1) Identify the Genius state to access and develop.

2) Fully Access your Intentional State about that State — Why?

Is that state important for you? Why? [Holding that answer} Why is that important?
[Keep asking 7 times until you have a very strong intentional state.]
What value will you experience when you have that state?
What is your biggest reason why? What is your core state at the highest level?
[Continue this until you flush out and detect a list of higher values.]

3) Step into the highest intentional state.

Confirm: That must be important to you? So welcome in the good feelings that these meanings invite, and just be with those higher level feelings for a bit. Do you like that? [Yes.]
Let those feelings grow and intensify as you recognize that this is your *highest Intentional Stance*, this is what you are all about . . . isn't it? Close your eyes and be with your highest intention and let it fill every fiber of your being.
How fully are you now experiencing this?

4) Link your highest intentional state to your genius state.

In just a moment, when you are ready, I want you to open your eyes and look at your genius state/event with all of these higher intentions in mind.
Take these highest intentions and *look at that content* and notice how it aligns your attentions so your attentions can now do serve for your intention.
With this in mind, how well will you now be able to focus and concentrate?
As you bring your biggest reason why into the genius state that you want to develop, and notice how it energizes your state. How is that for you?

5) Commission your executive mind.

There's a part of your mind that makes decisions, will that highest executive part of your mind take full responsibility to access this intention of your big Why whenever you are engaged in this activity so you can see the world this way?
Imagine taking this intentional stance and moving out into tomorrow with them.
What will remind you of this state? What will anchor it for you?

META-STATING SELF

This is the most basic meta-state process for working with and inducing *three basic self states,* self-acceptance, self-appreciation, and self-esteem. Use it to establish a solid core for centering yourself, for setting a frame of value and worth for oneself, and for operating with self-esteem even in the face of dignity-denying or threatening experiences. On a continuum of *liking* and *welcoming* something into your world we have the following distinctions:

Rejection	***Acceptance***	***Appreciation***	***Esteem***
Dislike Judgment Rejection	Welcoming — Inviting in Non-Judgment W/o endorsement Acknowledge but no condoning or endorsing	Gentle openness Welcome warmly with attraction / love	Highly valuing as important Significant, worthwhile Welcome with Awe, Honor
	— Doing —		**— Being / Person —**

Distinctions:

- You will here create a sliding anchor to indicate "more and more" of something.
- You will use the states of acceptance, appreciation, and awe to create three powerful meta-states.
- Self-esteem is unconditional — based on an evaluation or judgment of the mind.
- Self-confidence is conditional — based on competency and experience.
- Separating and distinguishing self-confidence and self-esteem is one of the most important distinctions you'll ever make.

Elicitation Questions:

- Do you ever judge your self as a human being? Or, do you ever put yourself down? Or contempt yourself, insult yourself, etc.? Do you have low self-esteem; do you have high self-esteem?
- Do you ever confuse yourself as a human being with what you do?

Format:

Do this pattern sitting down, ask to use the person's arm to set up a *slicing anchor*. Check if the person prefers moving up the arm as "more" or down the arm.

The Pattern:

1) Identify a self-contempting experience.

Have you ever thought or felt in a way that's contemptful toward yourself? Have you ever hated yourself, insulted yourself, despised yourself? Or perhaps you just did not treat yourself with kindness. As you recall an event like that; after you do, notice how you thought and felt contempt toward yourself. Now set that reference aside for the time being.

2) Access the three resource states of Acceptance, Appreciation, and Awe.

Access each state (by using a small and simple referent) so that you feel each of these states in a full and discreet way.

A) *Acceptance*:

What do you accept that you could reject? What small and simple thing do you easily accept without particularly liking or wanting, but you welcome it in? (Examples: rain, traffic, changing the baby's diaper, taking out the trash, etc.)

[Anchor this with a touch on the arm in preparation for sliding it for "more."]

B) *Appreciation.*

Is there anything that you really appreciate? That you melt in appreciation? (Examples: walking on a beach, backrub, soaking in a hot tub, good conversation, listening to music, seeing beautiful sunrise, etc.) See and hear it as specifically as possible and when you do–*feel this.* [more your hand on the arm to a place for "appreciation."]

C) *Awe.*

What is so big, so wonderful, so marvelous, so incredible that you stand in awe of it, speechless, in utter wonder? (Examples: seeing the milky way galaxy on a clear night, seeing one of the wonders of the world, presence of royalty, your sense of God, etc.). Feel that sense of awe and as you do, *feel this* [anchor a spot for awe, slide your hand to this spot].

3) Establish a sliding anchor that connects the three states.

As you access and amplify each state (so that you end up with three robust states of these resources), set them up as a sliding anchor of the continuum of these states that "welcome" things.

Explanation: *Acceptance* welcomes "what is" by acknowledging it. This ends the fight of rejection and allows whatever exist to exist. *Appreciation* welcomes what you value and appreciate. It welcomes what you find as precious. *Awe* or esteem welcomes what stands as among the highest, ultimate, and most sacred values.

After you access each state— **break state.** Take a moment and then test. Do we have each of these states anchored so that this touch [fire the anchor] calls *the feeling* (of acceptance, appreciation, and awe) to you? Notice what happens when I do this [fire each anchor, one at a time as you slide to the three spots].

4) Apply each state to self.

Explanation: Now that you have these three states accessed and sequence, you can now use them to build three powerful meta-states. Start with *acceptance.*

As you now *feel this sense of acceptance* [touch the anchor] I wonder what things about yourself that you want to just *accept* [touch anchor]? I wonder what you might find challenging to accept—your shadow side, some experience, the cards that life dealt you, that you might now just *feel this.* And what else could you accept that would improve the quality of your life? [Fire the acceptance anchor *as you hold* the acceptance anchor.]

As you now *feel appreciation* [fire the anchor] I wonder what you can *feel this* about—your skills, your gifts, your talents, your potentials? And you can *feel appreciation* for your mental powers, emotional powers, linguistic powers, and behavioral powers. And as you *feel this appreciation about yourself* [anchor] I wonder what else you can *just accept* [first acceptance anchor]?

As you now *feel awe and esteem* [anchor it] feel this about yourself —*you* are valuable, precious, worthy, and a magnificent human being, *you* are unconditionally sacred and loveable. And *feeling this esteem* [fire anchor], I wonder what else you can appreciate about yourself [fire appreciation anchor]? And feeling this unconditional worth, I wonder

what else you can just *accept* [fire acceptance anchor] about yourself?

Now ... *feeling this awe and esteem* for yourself ... fully and completely, letting it grow and expand ... that's right, now notice what else you can *appreciate* [fire anchor] and what else you can just *accept* [fire anchor] more gracefully and easily. That's right. How's that?

5) Apply self-esteeming, appreciating, and accepting in needed contexts

Now at a rate and speed just right for you, feeling this *esteem* for who you *are* and *appreciation* for what you can do— holding this strong— bring in that trigger that used to evoke self-contempt or self-dislike and notice how *this* [anchor both esteem and appreciation anchors] changes that? As you think about that old trigger or situation, *feel this esteem* [fire esteem anchor] for yourself knowing that your worth and value is a given and *feel this appreciation* [fire appreciation anchor] for what you can do so that you focus there, and *feel this acceptance* [anchor] for the things that just are that you have to deal with.

Especially notice how *feeling this esteem and self-awe* [fire awe anchor] at the mystery of you and your potentials it transforms this old context. How is that?
Do you like that? Would that make a difference?
Are you ready to self-respect yourself from this day forward —no matter what?
Are you ready to step into unconditional self-esteem fully and make it your default program?

6) Put into your future and validate.

Imagine moving through life in the weeks and months to come with this frame of mind. . . . Do you like this?
Notice how this will transform things for you . . .
Does every aspect of the higher parts of your mind fully agree with this?
Are you now un-stoppable?

Using Meta-Stating Self in "APG in Stages"

Again, do either before or after. Your choice!

1) Identify your Genius State.

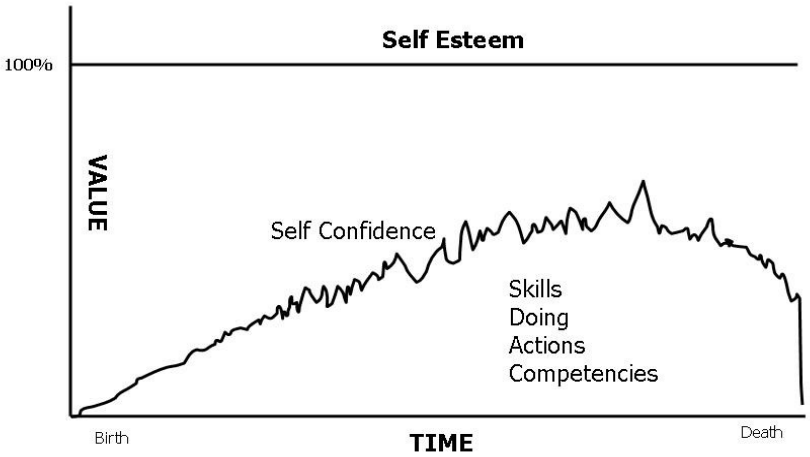
What is it?

2) Re-Access your Intentional State.

Why do this? What is your biggest why? Is your *why* robust enough?

3) Access your Power Zone State — How?

Do you fully know how to do this?
What are your most powerful mental, emotional, linguistic, and behavioral expressions of this?


Self Esteem
100%
VALUE
Self Confidence
Skills
Doing
Actions
Competencies
Birth
TIME
Death

META-STATING BELIEF CHANGE
Meta-Yes-ing

A belief is a confirmed state. In some way and for some reason, you have come to say "yes" that thought is true or real. And when you do that, you *construct* a "belief." Here we use "yes" and "no" to create confirmation and dis-confirmation states. This will enable us to *change limiting beliefs.* It offers a clear, quick, and effective way to deframe the old belief that limits and to install the empowering beliefs that support your commitment to success.

The "yes" and "no" states are two states you learned early in life. *Yes* expresses the idea of *confirmation* and *no* expresses the idea of *dis-confirmation.* Saying *yes* welcomes things into your world—ideas, emotions, experiences, people, etc. Saying *no* sets up boundaries, distinguishes between "me" and "not me," and pushes things out of your world. This pattern replaces the old NLP pattern that attempted to change *beliefs* with sub-modalities.

Distinctions:

When you confirm something, you say yes to it. That transforms a thought into a belief.
Dis-confirmation (saying no) transforms a belief back to a mere thought.
Thoughts come and go; beliefs stay as "commands to the nervous system."
The brain has no innate quality control mechanism; *you* have to do the quality controlling.
Because your beliefs are commands and powerful, be careful what you believe.
Beliefs are sentences and empowering beliefs are usually opposites of limiting beliefs.

Elicitation Questions:

Do you have any beliefs that limit you or sabotage your best performances?
Do you have any belief that undermines your best or prevents your development?

Cavet:

There is no ecology in this pattern. Therefore make sure that the new belief is ecological by considering its consequences if you commission it to govern your nervous systems.

The Pattern:

1) Identify the limiting and empowering beliefs.

Ecology for this pattern must occur before you begin the pattern. Make sure you have a *high quality idea* that you want to confirm and transform into a belief.

What enhancing and empowering beliefs would you really like to have running in your mind-and-emotions? What beliefs stand in your way?
How does this belief sabotage you or undermine your effectiveness?
Have you had enough of it? Or do you need more pain? [Write down the limiting belief.]
What empowering belief would you like to have in its place?
Is the new idea realistic? Is it useful, productive, enhancing in all aspects of your life?
[Write down the enhancing belief.]

2) Access a strong and robust state of "No!"

Think of something that every fiber in your body can say **"No!"** to in a way that is fully congruent.

Menu: Would you push a little child in front of a speeding bus just for the hell of it?
Would you eat a bowl of dirty filthy worms when you have delicious food

available?

Say that *"No!"* again and again while you take a moment to notice it, make an internal snapshot of it so that you know how it feels, how you breath, look, sound, hold your posture, etc.

Anchor your *"No!"* with your hand gestures. Feel it. Hear your voice of "No!"

3) Apply your "No!" to THE ECOLOGY of the limiting belief.

Ask a series of questions: Do you want this (limiting) belief? Does it serve you? Enhance your life? Empower you as a person? [Design: to elicit a strong "no."]

Evoke a strong feeling of a powerful "*No!"* (even *"Hell No!"*) as you think about wanting to keep the belief that you know is stupid, useless, limiting belief.

And you can keep on saying *No!* to the value of the limiting belief until you begin to feel that you have dis-confirmed it and it no longer has any power over you, that it has no more room in your presence, in your mind.

How many more times and with what voice, tone, gesturing, do you need to totally disconfirm the old belief so that you know—deep inside yourself—that it will no longer run your programs?

4) Access a strong and robust "Yes!"

[Make a clean break state between the "no" and "yes" states.]

Think about something that every fiber of your being says *"Yes!"* to without any question or doubt. Do you have anything like that?

Notice your **"Yes!"** Notice the neurology and feeling of your **"Yes!"** Notice the voice of **"Yes!"**

How do you best gesture **"Yes!"** with your hands and body so it amplifies the feelings?

How much have you amplified your **"Yes!"?**

5) Meta "Yes!" the ECOLOGY of the enhancing belief.

As you feel this *"Yes!"* let's make it a strong emotional *yes* and now repeatedly say it to the empowering belief that you want to send a command to your nervous system.

Do you want this? **[***"Yes!"***]** Really?

How many more times do you need to say *"Yes!"* right now in order to feel that you have fully welcomed it into your presence and neurology?

6) Validate the "Yes!" with more Yeses. [Use this to test your work.]

This is only an exercise and so you can't keep this! Oh, you want this?

You really want this? Will this improve your life?

Will it be valuable to you? Will it make a difference in your life?

Will it enable you to unleash new potentials?

The Key: This pattern does *not* address *the content* of the belief, but the validation of the ecology of the belief. Say *No* to the limiting belief's ecology: "It is not ecological." Say *Yes* to the new belief's usefulness and ecology: "Yes, it is enhancing, empowering, effective, etc."

Using Meta-Stating Confirmation/ Dis-confirmation for APG in Stages

1) What beliefs limit you in your "genius" state?

Pick one and use it with this pattern.

Make sure it is ecological: good for your mind-body-emotion-relational system.

META-STATING PLEASURE

While *pain* and *pleasure* are two primary states, in this pattern you will explore your subjective experiences of pleasure and the meta-levels of what we call "happiness." Doing so will enable you to more fully understand and explain your motivation, your values, and even addiction patterns. Why does something "mean" as much as it does to you? Somehow you have attached a meta-level of pain or pleasure to it.

Distinctions:

- Your body is wired for a thousand pleasures *and* those pleasures have natural thresholds.
- As pleasures-of-pleasures, you have meta-pleasures. By these you can, and do, over-ride the natural thresholds of your pleasures. Giving pleasure to your pleasures creates the gestalt of values and semantically loads things with rich and governing meanings.
- You can link pleasure to anything! *Anything.* To what would you like to give more pleasure?
- As you move up the levels, listen for "edge-of-the-map" language: just, only, obviously, "that's the way it is," is, really, etc. These words will let you know when you are at the top of one's mapping. Ask, "Anything above this?" Expect and look for lots of looping and synonyms. This is where you get to go for a ride—enjoy the trip!

- Distinguish *expressions* of a state (feelings, actions, urges) and *the frames* of the state. Before you move up another level, ask:
  - Is this just another synonym of that previous pleasure?
  - How do I express this state? What feeling?
  - What I feel like doing about the state? Actions
  - Is this a meta-level of thinking-and-feeling about the state?

Elicitation Questions:

What do you do for fun that is so over-loaded with pleasure, you are highly motivated? What primary pleasure is so pleasurable that you would pay to get to engage in?

Preparation Step: Make a *fun list.* What things that you do *just for pleasure?*

Menu*:* Taking a hot bath, watching a sunset, playing with a kitten, reading a book, taking a walk, sexual intimacy, etc. Pick something small and simple—yet full of pleasure for you. Include anything that gives you a sense of enjoyment.

The Pattern:

1) Identify a pleasure and fully describe it.

What are 2 or 3 things you really enjoy? What is on your *fun list?*

"What I really have fun doing, experiencing, seeing, etc. is . . ." Now describe that pleasure in its sensory-based features. Complete the sentence: what I really enjoy is... What do you see, hear, feel, smell or taste?

2) Identify your first meta-states about the pleasure.

Take the primary pleasure that you really like and generate as many answers as you can to the question: *What is the* ***pleasure*** *of that pleasure?* Or, *What is the value of that primary pleasure?* Or, It must be meaningful to you, what is the meaning of it?

[Get the first line meta-state pleasures, 3 to 5 of them, then begin to go up from those.]

If *that* is pleasurable, *what is the pleasure* of that pleasure?

3) Move up the levels as you identify the meta-state frames.

If that is pleasurable to you, what is the pleasure of that pleasure?

What does this positive meaning of value and significance mean to you?

- Sketch or diagram the meta-level structure and keep repeating.
- Draw a circle to designate your primary pleasure with each answer as a "state" of meaning and feeling *about* that pleasure.
- Continue to repeat this process for all of the higher-level pleasurable meanings that you give to the primary pleasure. For each ask the questions above.

4) Step back to appreciate the whole (gestalt) of the pleasure experience.

As you step back in your mind, notice all of the meanings, beliefs, understandings, values, decisions, and states that *drive* your pleasure. Do you now know why it holds so much meaning for you?

Does this really, in the long term, enhance your life?

Does it empower you as a person?

If you took away one line of states about it—how much would that reduce your enjoyment?

5) Step in to fully experience the pleasure then begin to spread it around your world.

What other everyday activity would you now like to creatively imagine using as a trigger to generate this feeling of meta-pleasure? To what would you like to *spread this pleasure*?

6) Future pace and confirm.

Future Pace: Imagine fully being in this state in some particular context doing that activity, and how is that? Do you like that?

Will you keep this decision and spread pleasure to the new activities from now on?

Using the Pattern for "APG in Stages"

1) Identify your Genius State.

What genius state are you developing?

2) Re-Access your Intentional State about that State and your biggest Why?

Why do this? What's your highest intention?

3) Access your Power Zone State — How?

Do you feel empowered in your thinking, feeling, speaking, and behaving?

Do you know how to do this? Do you know the core competencies to develop?

4) Access your Strongest Sense of Self — Who?

Do you have a strong enough sense of self to lose yourself in the genius engagement?

DE-PLEASURING

Meta-Stating to Counter-Act Addictions

This pattern repeats the first 4 steps of the *Pleasure Pattern*. Start with a sensory-based primary pleasure that you do **not** want to over-load with pleasure. Use this pattern to reduce the level of pleasure you take in a thing, idea, experience, etc. such as smoking, over-eating, drinking, shopping, TV shopping, etc. Use this to reduce negative addictions.

Distinctions:

You can over-load a pleasure or even a pain to your detriment.
As you can pleasure yourself at meta-levels, you can remove pleasure and meaning.
Addictions need to be de-pleasured to deprive them of their driving influence and power.

Elicitation Questions:

What have you over-loaded with so much meaning and pleasure that it now undermines your well-being?
Do you have any pleasure that you would like to de-pleasure and regain your well-being and freedom?

The Pattern:

1) Identify disliked pleasure.

What primary level pleasures have taken on far too much meaning and value in your life that you would like to devalue and reduce in meaning and pleasure?

2) Identify the meta-state levels of meaning that drive it all the way up the Matrix.

What positive meaning of value and significance do you give to this pleasure? Again, draw a circle designating your primary pleasure with each answer as a "state" of meaning and feeling *about* that pleasure.
What are the higher-level pleasurable meanings that you give to the primary pleasure?
What positive meaning of value and significance do you give to this pleasure?
What does this positive meaning of value and significance mean to you?

3) Sketch out the full enjoyment/happiness structure with all of its meta-levels.

Fully articulate the meanings, values, beliefs, understandings, etc. that drive and give meaning and value to the experience.

4) Appreciate the gestalt that drives the pleasure and quality control it.

Sit back and notice all of the meanings, beliefs and states that *drive* your pleasure. This provides insight as to why it "holds so much meaning" for you.
Does this in the long run empower you as a person or enhance your life? Do yo need this?

5) Explore its structure.

Put your hand over one set of meta-level meanings. If you took away one line of states about it, how much would that reduce your enjoyment? How many of the meanings do you need to take away before it ceases to exist as just whatever it *is* at the primary level eating, drinking, etc.?

6) Commit yourself to de-pleasure the old pleasure.

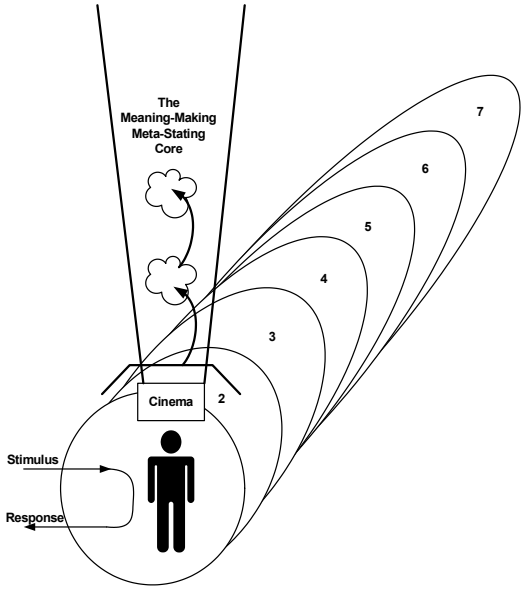
Decide at the meta-level that you will not give the primary pleasure that much meaning, significance, or value. Or, just say *"No!"* to the old pleasure. "This is *just* food..." (Decide to refuse to accept this meaning for the experience.)

Use "edge of the map" type of words and expressions: only, just, it is...

Set frames that limit the meaning.

7) Future pace the de-enjoyment.

Go to your highest meta-pleasure states and access fully. Allow your creative part to identify other behaviors that you can do that will allow you to experience this meta-level meaning... Imagine fully stepping into this state and experiencing it fully *and realizing fully* that you can do so without needing to engage in that behavior.



DAY 2

CLEARING THE PATH

FOR A NEW MATRIX

Menu:

1) Meta-Stating Troubling Emotions
2) Meta-Stating Concepts
3) Dancing with Dragons
4) Meta-Stating Implementation for actualizing knowledge
5) Meta-Stating Possibilities using the "As If" Frame

META-STATE DISTINCTIONS

Yesterday you began learning the Meta-States Model. What did you learn? Questions to direct your learning.

What is a Meta-State?

A state of consciousness *above, beyond, and/or about* (meta) any other state of consciousness. An order of abstraction *about* another order of abstraction, "a second-order abstraction," an executive state that runs, governs, modulates, and organizes one's everyday states, a frame of reference, a semantic or conceptual state, an attitude.

What is the mechanism that drives and creates Meta-States?

Your self-reflexive consciousness which reflecting back upon itself recursively thereby creating a *system*. Every time you go *meta* you move to a higher level and layer another level.

What is reflexivity?

It is the infinite regress in philosophers that we call *the infinite progress.* As a never-ending process, you can always go meta, step back from your state, and abstract one more time. You can *always* think about your thinking (meta-thinking), talk about your talk, feel about your feelings, model your model, etc.

What does the relational structure of level upon level do in terms of shifting "aboutness?"

While primary states refer to external content: "I'm afraid **of** John," meta-states refer to the

previous state: "I'm afraid of my fear." "I'm disgusted with my anger." As a state-about-a-state, when you shift logical levels you change what the start is *about.*

What does it mean that there are emergent properties in gestalt states*?*

Reflexivity involves feedback loops so as a *systemic process* new things emerge. *Emergence* occurs. New qualities arise which are non-summary or non-additive. From the gestalt a new activity emerges that gives a "structure-as-a-whole" feeling.

What is the power and pervasiveness of "logical levels?"

The higher the level, the more it governs, modifies, modulates, controls, drives, and organizes the previous states. Primary states are *not* as *important* as meta-states. Gregory Bateson (1972) specified this principle that meta-messages always modify lower-level messages.

"META"

(above, about, beyond)

The Power to Rise Above

NEURO-SEMANTICS

Yesterday you also began learning some of the special terms in Neuro-Semantics. These terms primarily come from General Semantics and Meta-Cognition.

Coalescing.

By the process of *repetition and habituation* higher frames or states eventually ***coalesce*** into the previous states. It comes from the *transcending* and *including* function when you meta-state. Meta-states do not stay "meta," they merge into the previous state to texture and qualify, to embody and integrate. In this way we create perceptual filters (meta-programs).

Modulating.

Modulating refers to the controlling influence the higher states have over the previous. They dominate, organize, and modulate the lower. The higher operates as a self-organizing influence or attractor over the previous.

Gestalt and Gestalting.

A "gestalt" arises as a larger configuration that is more than the sum of the parts. As a systemic process, it establishes an inter-active system (i.e. our mind-body neuro-linguistics). In this context *emergent properties* arise. As we *think strategically* about the effect of level-upon-level we can check the ecological value of a particular meta-stating structure.

Multi-Ordinality.

Multi-ordinal refers to a word or mental concept that occurs at many different levels. Many terms describe a *mental phenomena* that can be experienced at many levels. Multi-ordinality distinguishes the levels to create clarity. A *multi-ordinal* term is ambiguous until you know the *level.* Ask, *"At what level are you using that word?"* Source: Alfred Korzybski's *Science and Sanity.*

Multi-Ordinality means we can build *thoughts at many different levels*. If you don't notice the levels, you will confuse them. That then creates confusion and all sorts of category errors. So, all thoughts are equal and don't occur at the same level. An idea can be coded by the same word although occurring at many different levels. (See *Communication* Magic, 2001)

META-STATING TROUBLING EMOTIONS

Emotions can trouble a person. They can be troubling by being too much, too unexpected, too confusing. At a meta-level, anytime you bring a *negative emotion against* yourself, you put yourself at odds with yourself. *You are in self-attack!* As this turns your psychological energies against yourself, it creates all sorts of trouble: dysfunctions, self-conflict, "dragon" states, etc. Use this pattern for handling emotions that trouble you, whether positive or negative. This gives us an art of handling emotions effectively and intelligently.

Distinctions:

- An emotion is the difference between your mapping of the world and how you experience the territory of the world.
- Emotions give signals and messages about that difference between map and territory.
- Emotions are just emotions and not commands, and not infallible orders.
- You manage your emotions well when you accept them and use them for information about whether to adjust your map or improve your coping skills.
- This pattern is about primary emotions. If someone gives you a meta-emotion, question until you have identified the primary emotion/s that is troubling the person.

Elicitation Questions:

What emotion do you not like? Which one do you not have a good relationship with? What emotion or emotions do you try to banish from your life?

The Pattern:

1) Identify an emotional state that troubles you.

What emotional state do you not like? Which one can you not stand? What state do you hate and wish you didn't experience? What states do you feel as "taboo?"

[With the emotion you have chosen, ask:]

What is the emotion about? [contextualize]
Is it appropriate? Is it realistic? How intense is it?
If the emotion is not appropriate, what emotion would be?

Menu list: anger, fear, disgust, sexual feelings, sensitivity, embarrassment, sadness, etc.
[Make sure the emotion is a *primary emotion,* and not a meta-feeling which is actually a judgment. Use the Concept pattern for those.]

Describe this state. How is this a problem? What do you think-and-feel about this? [You are now looking for the meta-levels.]

2) Check your permission level with that emotion.

Quiet yourself and go inside. Now say the words: "I give myself permission to feel X...." Notice your internal responses as you say these words. What are you aware of? What happens?

How well does that settle inside? How many more times do you have to give yourself this permission before it will settle very well and be okay within you?

Are there any objections to this permission? If there are, what are the objections?

[Repeat the permission incorporating the objection into the permission. An objection indicates a hidden frame *forbidding* it because it means something. Identify it and reframe.]

3) Keep framing and reframing the permission so it becomes well-designed.

As you give yourself permission congruently with a resourceful voice, set frames and reframes to the objections that set new meanings. How does that settle?

Examples:

"I give myself permission to feel anger because it allows me to recognize things that violate my values and to take appropriate action early."

"I give myself permission to feel the tender emotions because it makes me more fully human."

[Keep meta-modeling until you have reframed it or relativized it.]

4) Add resources to qualify and texture the emotional experience.

What resources would you need to access in order to more fully accept this?

Menu List: Acceptance, appreciation, calmness, patience, resilience, curiosity, etc.

Access each and apply to the permission for a new meta-strategy.

5) Quality control the permission.

Imagine moving into tomorrow and the day after and next week and next month with these new frames in your permission for welcoming the emotion that did trouble you ... are you fully aligned with this? Do you have any objection to letting this operate as your way of being in the world?

6) Future Pace to install.

As you imagine this, do you like this?

Are you ready to make this yours?

Will you keep this?

How will you remember it?

Using the Pattern for "APG in Stages"

1) Identify your Genius State.

What is the genius state that you're developing?

2) Re-Access your Intentional State about that State and your biggest Why?

What is your highest intention for developing this genius state?

3) Access your Power Zone State — How?

Do you sense yourself at cause and with access to your powers in this state?

4) Access your Strongest sense of Self — Who?

Are you at your best self in this state? Can you be self-forgetful when here?

5) Access rich and delightful Pleasures to bathe this state in.

Do you know how to pleasure this state so it is enjoyable and fun?

6) Identify any troubling emotions.

Are there any emotions that trouble you and interfere with your genius state?

What emotion? What triggers it? When? With whom? In what context?

META-STATING CONCEPTS

Emotions are not the only thing that can trouble you, ideas can also. Concepts. You and I live our lives, *not only at primary levels,* but mostly at meta-levels. You live in, suffer from, and glory in, conceptual and semantic states. That's because we are a class of life that can develop a bad relationship with an idea—a concept. We live inside of concepts that make up much of our "reality."

Time	Justice/ Fairness	Money
The Past	Materialism	Saving
Men (masculinity)	Women (femininity)	Race
Cause (causation)	Emotionality	Power
Self	Culture	Manipulation
Self or Selfishness	Intellectuality	Victim
Human nature	Control	Failure
Relationship	Values	Sexuality
Motivation	Morality	Rejection
The meaning of life	Consequences	Criticism
Human destiny/purpose	Responsibility	Aging

We often think *about* external events which are related to meta-level concepts like time, causation, masculinity, femininity, etc. When you develop thoughts-feelings about those linguistic "realities" as abstractions, you develop higher structured states of beliefs and understandings about other beliefs and concepts. Some meta-states will have weak kinesthetic components because you code your layers of thoughts-and-feeling about other thoughts-and-feelings in abstract language. This shifts you from primary sensations (feelings) to secondary sensations (emotions), triary sensations (abstract emotions or judgments). You are still in a state, but a more abstract state and sometimes one in which we experience less of your kinesthetics.

Distinctions:

- As you draw conclusions you invent concepts or categories of reality.
- You can create a bad relationship to a concept so it pushes your buttons.
- Concepts are comprised of layers of meanings and understandings and are often ill-conceived so that it generates unuseful, even dysfunctional, assumptions.
- Revisit concepts to renew, reframe, and develop useful concepts for navigating life.
- This is a threshold pattern— you will make things worse before they get better.

Elicitation Questions:

What idea, concept, understanding, etc. pushes your buttons and rattles you?
What concept can you not stand, do not like, and find irritating or annoying?

The Pattern:

1) Identify a concept or idea that gives you problems.

What concept do you want to develop a better relationship with? What concept, understanding, or idea pushes your buttons? Finish the sentence: *"I have a problem with . . ."*? Or, *"I can't stand . . ."*?

Menu List: authority, dependency, women, intimacy, entitlement, freedom, morality, vulnerability, criticism, fairness, failure, etc.

Are you ready for a better relationship with this concept?

2) Ground the concept to some real world trigger.

What triggers or sets off this idea or concept? When and where does it happen?
In what context? What event or events elicit this response in you?
Describe the sensory-components of the trigger, the see-hear-feel variables to ground the *stuck* experience. *[These questions will lead to grounding the concept.]*

3) Enter and explore the matrix of frames about the concept.

What do you believe about X?
[Use meta-questions to explore the frames. Enter the person's matrix with respect, no judgment.]
Let's say that is true ... if so, then what does that belief mean to you?
What do you expect? And what do you believe about that? [Track /Record the layers]

4) Quality control the construct of the concept.

[Once at the top, step aside to ask ecology questions about the whole matrix.]
Does this concept support you? Do you like it? Does it help you?
Does it enhance your life? Does it empower you as a person?
Is this conceptual framing useful? Is it healing?
If "Yes" — what value is there in it? Collect.
If "No" — are you ready to put this away? Whee will you send it?

5) Design a new more enhancing set of frames.

If you got to start all over and playfully imagine yourself in a state where you are not stuck— what state would that be? [Name the state.]
What do you need to believe to be in that state? What belief would hold that belief in place? What would all of that mean to you? [Go up 3 or so levels.]
Now image that you use these new meanings & beliefs. Would that enhance your life? Would you like that?

6) Future pace and confirm.

What difference will this new matrix make? Will you keep it? Is it yours?
Any objections? Any further resources?

Using the Pattern for "APG in Stages"

1) Identify your Genius State.

What is the genius state that you're developing?

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5) Access rich and delightful Pleasures to bathe this state in.

Do you know how to pleasure this state so it is enjoyable and fun?

6) Identify any troubling concepts.

Are there any concepts that trouble you and interfere with your genius state?
What concept? What triggers it? When? With whom? In what context?

META-STATING DRAGONS

If a *dragon state* is a toxic, limiting, dysfunctional, self-sabotaging state wherein you turn your energies, your thoughts and emotions against yourself, then they are another interference in your path to self-actualization, excellence, and the genius flow state. A *dragon state* is not merely a bad relationship with an emotion or a thought. It is more. It is a bad relationship with an event, a way of thinking, or an embodied state.

Bad relationships with Events.

You use some event that happened to yourself (or someone else) as your *reference point* for making meaning of life, yourself, human nature, trust, people, etc. The problem is that reference point— *that event. It is a sick and toxic example to use to build anything positive meaning from!* Typically it was an unfortunate, painful, traumatic, and completely inadequate representation. But build a set of maps from it, especially with a child's mind, and you can create a horrible, nasty, negative, destructive, depressive, and neurotic map that will not do you any good. The problem is the frame— the frame of reference that you are using.

Bad relationships with a Way of Thinking.

The *way* you think is your *cognitive style.* It exists at a higher level that *what* you think. In Meta-Stating Emotions and Concepts, we worked on erroneous and wrong things that you are thinking about emotions or ideas. The design was to change *what* you were thinking.

Above and beyond *what* you think is *how* you think. In Cognitive-Behavioral Psychology, this is know as the Cognitive Distortions. Most of them are *childish ways of thinking* that characterize how we began to learn to think as our young brains were beginning to learn. But what was cute and essential for a baby and then a child can be stupid, devastating, and destructive for an adult.

Bad relationship with a Way of Embodying a feeling in your Body.

Where and *how* you embody your cognitive awarenesses speaks about how you use your neuro-pathways, the messages you send to your body, and how your body tries to "actualize" those messages. Now the problem is your state— the felt state that you live in and operate from. Now the trauma reference event and cognitive distortions *live* in your neurology. To get it out of your neurology use the Movie-Rewind Pattern and the Drop-Down Through Pattern. The first takes the emotional charge out of the memory and the second releases the felt frames from your body.

META-STATING EVENTS AND COGNITIVE DISTORTIONS

When you are "cognitively wrong" (Maslow) your perceptions are fogging rather than clean. Mental and emotional pain arises not because you are emotionally sick, but because you are cognitively wrong. You are operating from a mistaken map. You have maps that simply do not enable you to navigate the territory very well. You have frames that build an unstable structure and foundation. You have not outgrown the childish thinking patterns that distort and leash your potentials. Every cognitive distortion that governs your perceptions creates misery and undermines your pathway to self-actualization. These cognitive distortions are based on deficiency-cognitions, rather than the *Being*-cognitions that inevitably facilitate self-actualization.

The Pattern

1) Identify the "dragon" event. [Questions to elicit the unresourceful state.]

What sabotages your from your highest and best? From your genius flow state?
What about that creates the sabotage? The problem? The limitation?
What do you use as your reference event or point when you think about that?
Has there been an especially hurtful or traumatic event in your life?
When you tell the story of your life to others or to yourself, what is the story?

2) Identify the "dragon" cognitive style/s.

How do you think about that event, its meanings, its significance, what it means about you and your life?
When you checklist the cognitive distortions, which ones stand out regarding your meanings?
What are the three biggest cognitive distortions that you have found so far?

3) Identify the "dragon" state that all of this creates.

What is the problem, difficulty, limitation, self-sabotage, neurosis that all of this creates for you?
Which one do you want to work on right now?

4) Identify the cognitive correction for the style of thinking and reasoning.

"It sounds like you are thinking about this using *Awfulizing.* As you step back from it, does it seem accurate?"
If so or if not, how else would you characterize your pattern of thinking and reasoning?
How long have you used this cognitive distortion in making meaning of things?
Has it served you well? In what way?
In what way may it have undermined your sense of well-being and accurate processing?
What is the cognitive correction that provides a more enhancing and accurate reasoning style?
What more useful way of processing this information would you like to use?
Are you willing to try it on and give it a chance?

Cognitive Distortions

1. Over-generalizing	Contextual thinking
2. All-or-nothing thinking	Both-and thinking; in-between thinking
3. Labeling	Reality-testing thinking
4. Blaming	Responsibility thinking
5. Mind-reading	Current sensory information
6. Prophesying	Tentative predictive thinking
7. Emotionalizing	Witness thinking or non-emotionalizing
8. Personalizing	Objective thinking
9. Awfulizing	Meta-cognitive thinking
10. Should-ing	Choice thinking
11. Filtering	Perspective thinking
12. Impossibility thinking: Can't-ing	Possibility thinking
13. Discounting	Appreciative thinking
14. Identifying	E-prime / dis-identifying thinking

5) Meta-state the cognitive distortion to reduce its influence.

What would you best like to do to reduce its power?
Would you like to challenge, dispute, and argue against Personalizing, Awfulizing, Should-ing, etc.?
Are you ready to identify and release these cognitive patterns?
What else will bring these patterns into the light where you can deal with them?
What else will break their power of working outside of consciousness?

6) Meta-state the referent event.

Are you clear that you have been using a poor, inadequate, disastrous, or toxic reference?
Are you willing to stop it? To refuse that reference?
Are you willing to begin to build and use more positive and life-enhancing references?
What references will you use from this day forward? Describe it fully.
As you take this on, what are the new beliefs you will create about this?

7) Meta-state the embodied trauma state.

Has the trauma state become physically *embodied?*
If so, where in your body do you feel it? How do you feel it?
Describe the sensations in your body using the kinesthetic distinctions (the cinematic distinctions or sub-modalities).
Be with and welcome those symptoms in your body and muscle memory and access the state of falling and dropping and *drop under those symptoms,* and what's there?
Repeat this 3 to 7 times (or more if necessary) [This is the Drop-Down meta-stating pattern].
Drop until there is nothing, then keep dropping until you reach 3 to 7 positive states, then take the strongest and most positive states and "clean the pipes" with it— bring it to and apply it to all of the symptoms in the body.

8) Future pace and confirm.

As you imagine moving forward with this today, tomorrow, this week ... how does this fit?
Are you fully aligned with this?
Are there any objections to this?

DRAGON DANCING

Stepping into your genius state of *personal mastery* means accessing highly resourceful states. Yet you cannot do that if you are in unresourceful states wherein you turn your energies against yourself. As long as internal conflicts are tearing you up, sabotaging your best efforts, turning your energies against yourself, or preventing your own congruence and alignment, you will not be able to step into the flow state of your personal genius fully. If you have *internal conflicts* of self-conflict and sabotage undermining your best efforts, your path to personal genius is not clear. Let's clear that path.

Dancing with your dragons involves five dance steps. These are *not* necessarily the order or sequence you will use. Start by attempting to name the dragon and then do whatever seems most appropriate as you *chase the dragon* and circle his cave. You may have to do that many times before you get the real dragon. This is a dance that you will be inventing as you go. Don't expect the dance to be sequential. It will not. Usually you will *dance with the dragon*, going round and round, repeated the steps again and again, flushing out the *real* dragon and slowly entering the dragon's lair as you discover the real issue in the back of the mind.

1) *Name* the dragon.
2) *Embrace* the dragon: kiss the dragon.
3) *Analyze* the dragon by using the Meta-Model sword of specificity.
4) *Starve* or interrupt the dragon.
5) *Frame* or meta-state the dragon.

Distinctions:

When you turn your thoughts and feelings against yourself, you attack yourself.
Such self-attack puts you at odds with yourself and undermines your resourcefulness.
"Dragons" is just a metaphor for the unresourceful state of being in self-conflict.

Elicitation Questions:

Do you have any dragons that put you into a strong unresourceful state?
What dragons do you have in your mind about your experiences?
How is a thought, a feeling, an experience, etc. a "dragon" to you?

Using this Pattern for "APG in Stages"

- Fully re-establish your genius state with its intentionality, power, solid sense of self, and pleasure.
- Identify a dragon state—*an unresourceful state*— that might or could occur when you begin to act from your optimal state.
    - Name it. What is it?
    - Embrace it. What happens when you accept it?
    - Analyze it. How do you create it?
    - Starve it. How do you feed it?
    - Frame it. How do you want to frame it so it does not bother you?
    -

Dancing with the Dragon Questions

1) Naming the Dragon:

- What state undermines your highest and best?
- How do know that it *limits* you, interferes with your passions, or undermines you?
- What do you call this dragon state?
- What else could you call this dragon?
- What name could we give this dragon that would be a funny, silly, even ridiculous name?

Or you can ask this: *In what area have you turned your psychic energy against yourself?*

What have you tabooed in your life and do you not allow yourself to experience?
What states, feelings, experiences, etc. are you intolerant about?
What *impulses* do you condemn as not acceptable?
What do you fear about X (any negative emotion)?

(Menu List: Disgust, hate, fear anger, embarrassment, shame, built, religious feelings, awe, optimism, hope, love, sexuality, revenge, to be grand and glorious, to hurt someone, etc.)

Self-Expectancies as internal Dragons.

Take an event or experience and complete 5 to 12 statements about what you expect of yourself when that happens. Write without censoring what *comes to mind.* Let whatever thoughts come and intrude.

2) Embracing and Kissing the Dragon:

- Is it just a negative emotion or experience? If so, what happens if you just embrace it as a negative emotion or experience?
- Do you have permission to accept it as such?
- Yes I can see that you don't like it or want it, yet are you willing to just acknowledge or accept it?
- What happens when you go inside and give yourself permission to experience it?

3) Analyzing the Dragon:

Language drives and encodes most meta-states. Language frames ideas *about* our emotions and experiences and constructs meaning. Too often we construct *dis-empowering meanings* because we over-generalize, delete important distinctions, engage in various cognitive distortions, etc. We end up with dragons made up of *painful meanings* that undermine our resourcefulness. As we create this messes by language, by de-languaging we can de-frame and pull our dragons apart. Use Meta-Model questions to challenge an experience and un-glue dis-empowering meanings. When does this dragon state occur? How intense is it?

- What do you think about it? What does it mean to you when you experience it?
- Have you turned any of your mental or emotional energies *against* yourself?
- What have you turned against yourself? In what way? To what extent?
- How does this unresourceful state feel like a dragon to you?
- When did you learn to think-feel this way?
- Who taught you to experience this in this way?
- What do you believe about this dragon state?
- What conclusions have you drawn from that experience?
- What does this experience say about you as a person? About your success and

effectiveness? About your relationships? About your future? What understandings and expectations have you created from it?

- Do you *have to* (should or must) have or experience what you want or is it just your desire and preference?
- If you *have to*, then why do you have to? What is the rule or command or paradigm that *demands* it?
- What happens if you say, "I want it and prefer it but don't have to have it?"
- Does this enhance your life or empower you as a person?
- Does it always work this way? Every time? For everybody?
- How do you know to call it by this term or phrase?
- What "causes" this? How does that work? How does X lead to Y?
- How do you *have to* feel or think when this happens?
- What are you presupposing in order for this to work in this way?

4) Starving the Dragon:

- As you hear yourself say that, is that the kind of thing you say that feeds your dragon?
- What else do you tell yourself that feed and nurtures the ole dragon?
- What happens when you eliminate that kind of self-talk and representations?
- What inner movies feed this ole dragon? What sights and sounds activate it?
- Do you have any barriers against the dragon?
- Are you ready to create a barrier by stubbornly refusing to let the dragon seduce you any more?
- What old self-talk needs to be eliminated?

5) Framing and meta-stating the Dragon:

- What resource would temper and texture your dragon state?
- As a menu list, what do you think about bringing acceptance, appreciation, self-value and esteem, fun and playfulness, curiosity, calmness, thoughtfulness, confidence, courage, love, respect, etc.?
- Which of these resources would enable and empower you to handle this state or experience more effectively?
- What empowering belief would handle this dragon state?
- What empowering decision, understanding, identity, intention, core question, etc.?
- Where is the dragon now?

MIND-TO-MUSCLE
Closing the Knowing-Doing Gap

The design of this meta-stating pattern is to turn highly informative, insightful, and valued principles into neurological patterns coded in your body. You do this when you learn to type on a keyboard. The original learning may take a considerable amount of time and trouble in order to get the muscle patterns and coordination deeply imprinted into your muscles. Yet by practicing and training, *the learnings become incorporated into the very fabric of the muscles themselves.* You then lose conscious awareness of the learnings as you let the muscles run the program. At that point, you have translated *principle into muscle.*

The same holds true for expertise, excellence, and mastery in all other fields, from sports, mathematics, teaching, to surgery, selling, and public relations. Begin with a *principle*—a concept, understanding, awareness, belief, etc., and then translate it into *muscle.* I have found this especially true in our modeling projects regarding resilience, leadership, wealth building, selling excellence, learning, coaching, etc. This pattern creates transformation by moving up and down the various levels of mind so that you map from your understandings about something from the lowest descriptive levels to the highest conceptual levels and back down again. Pick a great principle to coach your body how to feel. Pick one that's true and reliable, the ecology of this pattern lies in picking a good one.

Distinctions:

- Your mind-body system naturally enables you to incorporate or embody ideas.
- You incorporate higher level ideas into your muscle memory as you learn, use repetition, and invite those learnings into your body.
- Procedural knowledge can easily be put into the neurology of your muscle-memory.
- There's no ecology *inside* this pattern, choose an ecological principle to start with!

Elicitation Questions:

What concept do you *know intellectually,* but do not practice or live?
What great principle do you know in your mind that would make a great difference if you could only get yourself to *act upon it* and do it?

The Pattern:

1) Principle: Identify a principle you want incorporated into your muscles.

[Possible questions to use to elicit a principle.]
What principle do you want to put into your neurology?
What is your conceptual understanding of this idea?
What do you know (or understand or believe) about this that you want to set as a frame in your mind?
How do you state it in the a way that's clear, succinct, and compelling?
Use the sentence stem and fill it in — ***"I understand . . ."*** [If standing, step forward]

2) Belief: Describe the principle as a belief.

Are you ready to believe this? State the sentence as a belief and make personal.
Check: Do you believe it? Would you like to believe it?

If you really, really believed that, would that make a big difference in your life?
Start your sentence with — ***"I believe . . ."***

3) Decision: State the belief as a decision.

Would you like to live by that belief? [Yes.] You would? [Yes.] Really? [Yes.]
Will you act on this and make it your program for acting?
Start a sentence by using any of these prompters: ***"I will . . ." "I want . . . it is time to..." I choose to . . ."*** or ***"From this day forward I will ..."***

4) Emotion: State the Decision as a feeling or an experience.

As you state the belief decision, noticing what you feel, what do you feel?
What do you feel as you imagine living your life with this empowering belief and decision? [Whether positive or negative, state the emotion.]
Be with those emotions . . . let them grow and extend.
Say, — ***"I am feeling . . . I am experiencing ..."***

5) Action: Step forward and state as an action.

What one thing will you do tomorrow that will begin to manifest this in your life? And the day after that?
"The one thing that I will do today to make this real in my life is . . ."
[Answer needs to be a see, hear, feel answer that is specific and precise.]

6) Integrate: Embed the action with all these higher levels of mind.

As you fully imagine carrying out that one thing you will do today . . . seeing, hearing and feeling it you are doing this because you believe what? Because you've decided what? Because you feel what? And you will do what other thing? Because you understand what? Because you feel what? Because you've decided what? Because you believe what? And what other thing will you do?

[If you are doing this pattern standing up and walking, establish a spatial anchor for each and walk the person back through the experience, then come forward.]

Using this Pattern for "APG in Stages"

- Fully re-establish your genius state with its intentionality, power, solid sense of self, and pleasure.
- Identify several *principles* (great ideas) governing the area of your engagement "flow" state. Use this pattern to install them so you *feel* them— you commission your body to live those principles.

META-STATING NEW POSSIBILITIES
Miracle Question Pattern

A prerequisite of mastery (genius) is the creativity of pretending and imagining that allows us to think outside the box. Steve de Shazer created the "Miracle Question" in Brief Therapy. We here use it to *step aside* and *out of* the problem space so that we can do a *different kind of thinking*. This empowers us to engage in some solution-oriented thinking. This pattern utilizes fully *the "as if" frame* in order to construct a new outframing perspective.

Steve de Shazer's Miracle Question

> "Suppose that tonight after you go to bed and while you're sleeping, a miracle happens, and the problems that brought you here were immediately solved, gone like that [snap fingers], now you have what you have longed for. Yet because you were asleep, you don't know and cannot know that it happened or how it happened. How will you discover that a miracle happened? How will your loved ones? What will be different? What will you notice?"

Distinctions:

- Because *the very thinking* which creates problems more often than not cannot solve the problem, you will need to step into a new space in order to think out-of-the-box.
- The ability to pretend (use the *as if frame)* enables you to entertain new possibilities, to image solutions beyond the normal constraints of your thinking.

Elicitation Questions:

- What prevents you from "getting on the highway of life and putting the pedal to the metal?" What holds you back from going for your biggest dream?

The Pattern:

1) Identify and ground a stuck state. [Questions to elicit a subject to work with.]

What prevents you from living fully and happily? What holds you back?
What words and/or ideas arise when you think about stepping forward to do something that you want to do and see others doing (X)?
Where and when do you feel stuck? How do you know you are stuck?
What is your stuck state like? How strong is it? What is the trigger?

2) Identify your beliefs-about-beliefs structure (the Matrix you've built).

What do you believe that causes you to be stuck? What do you think about X?
What do you believe *about* that problem? What meanings do you give to it?
What thoughts come to mind? What meanings? [Get 2 or 3 meta-layers.]

3) Move all the way up the embedded frames to the full meta-level structure.

Let's say that belief is true, **if** so what would you believe about that?
If *that was true,* what would that mean to you?
Given that, what belief supports that limiting belief?

[As you identify the meta-state structure, layer upon layer, feel free to use a piece of paper to sketch out the list of beliefs or ideas.]

4) Quality control the full system of beliefs embedded within beliefs (your matrix).

Let's step aside from all of those ideas and beliefs for a moment.
Stepping back, what do you think about that matrix of beliefs?
Does that kind of thinking-and-feeling help? Does it make things better?
Does it empower you as a person? Have you had enough of that?
Are you ready for a different kind of thinking than what created that problem?

[If yes, move to the next step; if no, pull out any positive value or intention and keep running the quality control questions on what's left.]

5) Imagining the night of the miracle.

"Suppose that tonight after you go to bed and while you're sleeping, a miracle happens, and the problems that brought you here were immediately solved, gone like that [snap fingers], now you have what you have longed for. Yet because you were asleep, you don't know and cannot know that it happened or how it happened. How will you discover that a miracle happened? How will your loved ones? What will be different? What will you notice?"

Expand the Question:

Close your eyes. Imagine it's night and you've gone to bed. Suppose that tonight something special happens . . . a miracle happens and tomorrow you will wake up thinking-and-feeling in a completely different way . . . As you take your time to do this now ... doing it thoroughly and vividly, wonder ... really wonder what new thoughts-and-feelings and beliefs will you be accessing in this dream that will enable you to simply explode into tomorrow with grace, power, love, passion, and confidence? And you can wonder what state or states will you be in that will be different? And what supporting beliefs will empower you? Now when you are ready . . . I want you to open your eyes, move to this other chair . . . move to the chair of the day after the miracle . . .

[Expand and extend as needed using hypnotic language patterns.]

6) Describe the Day after...

"Open your eyes and move to the other chair..."

[Give the person a few moments to adjust ... as they do you will be setting the as if frame of the day after the miracle... Use the subjective case— "if this is ... what would...?]

If this was indeed the day after the miracle, how would you know?
What *would* be different? Describe this day after the miracle.
What else will be different?

[Keep asking for differences until you map out a new reality.]

Who would be the first to know? What would that person notice?

[Describe fully . . . accessing the states and beliefs.]

7) Ask about the meta-levels that support the new experience.

What belief would support this new experience? What values?
What new ideas or insights does this give you? [Map out the new meta-levels.]
Do you like that?

8) Confirm and future pace.

Do you like this?
Do you want to keep this?

Using this Pattern for "APG in Stages"

- Fully re-establish your genius state with its intentionality, power, solid sense of self, and pleasure. As you access rich and delightful pleasures, bathe your state in it. Access full permission for being fully in this state. Access the richest meanings that you can give to this state.
- ***Identify a problem that seems unsolvable.***
  What prevents you from your genius state? What holds you back from the excellence of your mastery state? Use this Miracle Question pattern to meta-state your creativity.

DAY 3:

QUALIFYING AND TEXTURING YOUR GENIUS STATE

Day Three Menu:

1) Meta-Stating Intentionality: Taking an Intentional Stance
2) Meta-Stating the state of Flow: Accessing Personal Genius
3) Meta-Stating Excuses: Excuse Blow-Out Pattern
4) Meta-Stating Congruence: Spinning Icons
5) Meta-Stating Integrity: Meta-Alignment

The Meta-States Model implies Thinking Systemically

As the processing of consciousness *reflects back onto* the products and processes, it feeds itself back into itself. *Feedback* from a state and set of interactions thereby re-enters the system and becomes part of the next stage of development of the state. The *feedback loop* creates the next level up. This feedbacking process creates a *self-organizing system* with the thinking-feeling feedback as *the attractor* for the meta-state. The content of our thinking becomes the attractor of the higher state or frame. And this, in turn, stabilizes in the meta-level formulation. It creates what we commonly call a "self-fulfilling prophecy." In this way, the meta-state generates an unconscious frame and stability.

Meta-States takes the linear TOTE Model of NLP and adds the holistic or systemic element of meta-levels. This allows us to create *a fuller model of modeling* that takes reflexive consciousness into account. Thoughts-and-feelings now feed back onto previous states. The somatic embodiment of the mind-emotional state generates a "field" of forces or energies and as the feedbacking process continues, it generates a systemic organization that continually elaborates upon itself, making it more layered and rich. In the field of Cognitive Psychology, Norman Holland has applied meta-cognitive processes by describing it in terms of *feedback loops governing feedback loops.*

INTENTIONALITY

META-STATING ATTRACTORS FRAMES AS A SELF-ORGANIZING NEURO-SEMANTIC SYSTEM

"*Self-organization theory* is a branch of systems theory that relates to the process of order formation in complex dynamic systems. Paradoxically, it arose from the study of chaos. Scientists studying chaos (the absence of order) noticed that when enough complexly interacting elements were brought together, rather than create chaos, order seemed to 'spontaneously' form as a result of the interaction.

According to 'self-organization' theory, order in an interconnected system of elements arises around are called *'attractors'*, which help to create and hold stable patterns within the system."

(Robert Dilts, *Strategies of Genius*, p. 255)

What is an Attractor?

In perceptual mapping, a focal point in a phenomenon around which the rest of our perceptions become organized. What are the lines or shadows that organize your perceptions to see young woman? Old woman?

In conceptual mapping, the *content* of some thought or feeling now pulls on other thoughts and feelings to support it. An idea that you value energizes and drives the neuro-semantic system.

How does an Attractor work?

It *configures* the images (representations) inside of a frame so that it *attracts* a certain way of seeing, hearing, feeling, languaging, or responding.

It structures the *foregrounding and backgrounding* of our perceptions and meta-programs.

It organizes the *computations* you use as you construct your model of the world—your beliefs. What you believe causes something (cause-effect) and what you believe something is (complex equivalence).

An attractor *magnetizes and organizes* the data so it fits the ideas, beliefs, values, etc. in the frame.

It *governs and modulates* your experiences as a kind of meta-filter and so sets up a self-fulfilling prophecy.

An attractor operates by feedback loops and governs those feedback loops.

It creates your own resonant signature for your unique style of moving through the world.

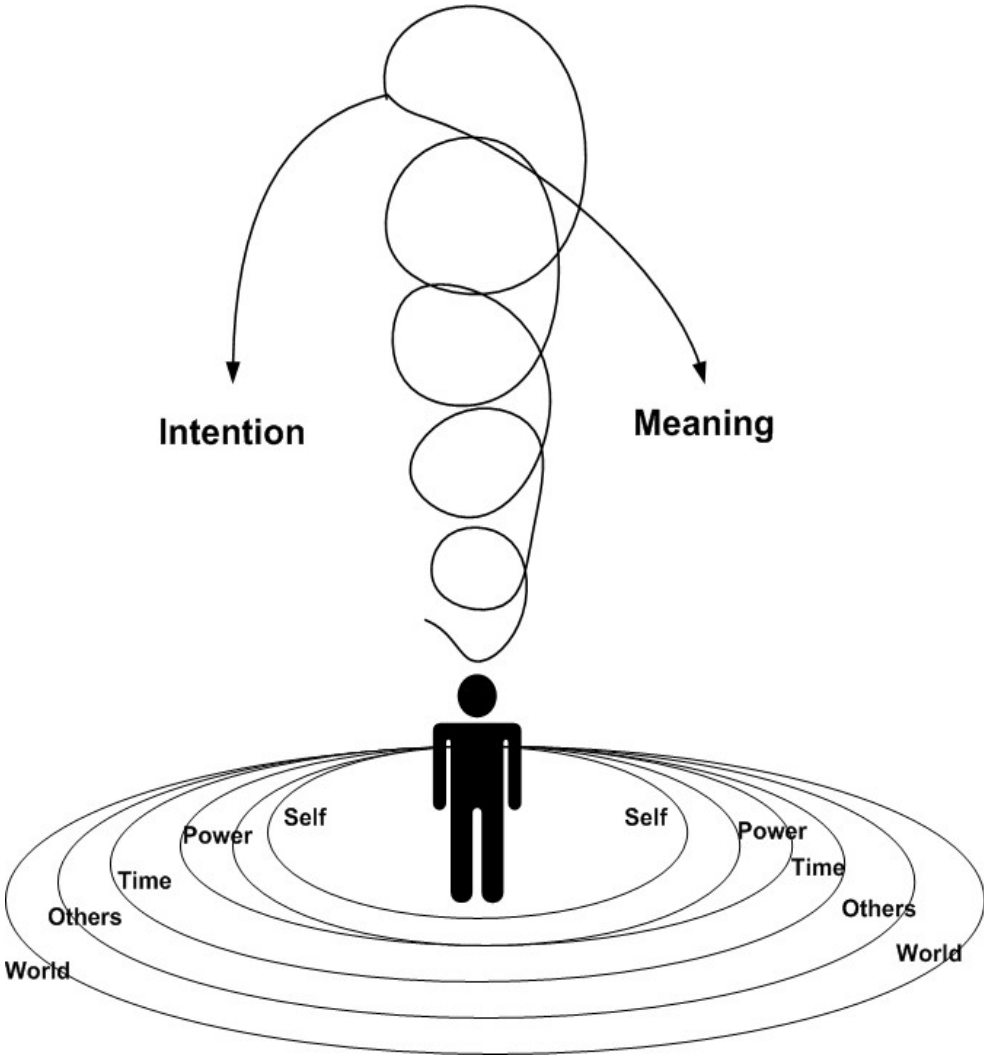
What are you Attracted To? What functions as an Attractor in Your World?

List the ideas, beliefs, understandings, values, experiences, references, etc. that tends to keep pulling on you.

What drives them? What empowers them?

Have you ever had an Attractor but it has become non-operational? What? How has it been de-commissioned? What de-stabilized the attractor? How did it become de-stabilized?

ENERGY FLOWS
WHERE ATTENTION GOES
AS DIRECTED BY INTENTION



INTENTIONALITY PATTERN

"He who has a why to live can bear almost any how." Friedrick Nietzsche

For this pattern, begin with any everyday activity. It can be an activity that you enjoy and love, feel turned on about, or it can be a highly dreaded activity—yet one that you know is important.

Distinctions:

- The attentional life is the life of an animal or small child.
- To live humanly and at our best, we must live intentionally—from our highest intentions.
- When attentions are aligned to our highest intentions, we develop a laser-beam focus.

Elicitation Questions:

- What do you *need* to do, because it's important to your long-term success, yet it does not *feel* important so you don't feel motivated to do it?
- What do you need to do that's important but you hard to maintain focus?
- What's important to do, but when you start, you experience an experience of ADD?

The Pattern:

1) Identify an activity that's important but that doesn't feel important. [Questions for eliciting]

What are some of the tasks that you engage in as part of your everyday life, career, etc.?
What do you need to do in order to succeed that you know is important but it does not feel important to you?
What activity do you have good intentions to do, but suffer from ADD (Attention Deficit Disorder) when it comes time to actually do it?

2) Explore the importance of the activity.

Why is that activity important to you? [Look for 1 and 2 word answers.]
Is this activity important and significant? *How* is it significant? *Why* is it valuable?
What else is important about that? Repeat 5 to 7 times.
[Each time *hold* the previous value and ask what is important bout *that* value.]

3) Continue the exploration up the meta-levels.

This activity is important because of these things, and why is this important to you?
What's important by having this? What important about that outcome?
And what's even more important than that?
And when you get that fully and completely and in just the way you want it, what's even more important?
[Continue this until you flush out and detect 5 to 7 levels of values.]

4) Step into the highest intentional state.

That' must be important to you? [Yes.] So just welcome in the good feelings that these meanings and significances invite, and just be with those higher level feelings for a bit. Do you like that? [Yes.]
Let those feelings grow and intensify as you recognize that this is your *highest intentionality,* this is what you are all about . . . isn't it? Close your eyes and be with your highest intention and let it fill every fiber of your being.

5) Link to the highest state to the primary context.

"Now in just a moment, when you are ready, I want you to open your eyes and look at that event that you started with, the event that you know is important but didn't feel important and look at it with all of these higher intentions in mind.

As you now take this highest intention [name it]— *look at that event* [the activity] and notice how it aligns your attentions so your attentions can now do serve for your intention.

With this in mind, will you now be able to focus and concentrate?

Imagine taking this intentionality and moving out into tomorrow with them.

6) Commission your executive mind to take ownership.

There's a part of your mind that makes decisions, will that highest executive part of your mind take full responsibility to access this intention of your big Why whenever you are engaged in this activity so you can see the world this way?

Imagine using this as *the basis of your inner life,* your way of being in the world. Do you like that?

Would that make a difference?

Would you be able to focus on this activity and complete it?

[Optional] ***Invite other resources.***

Would you like to bring any other resource to this intentionality?

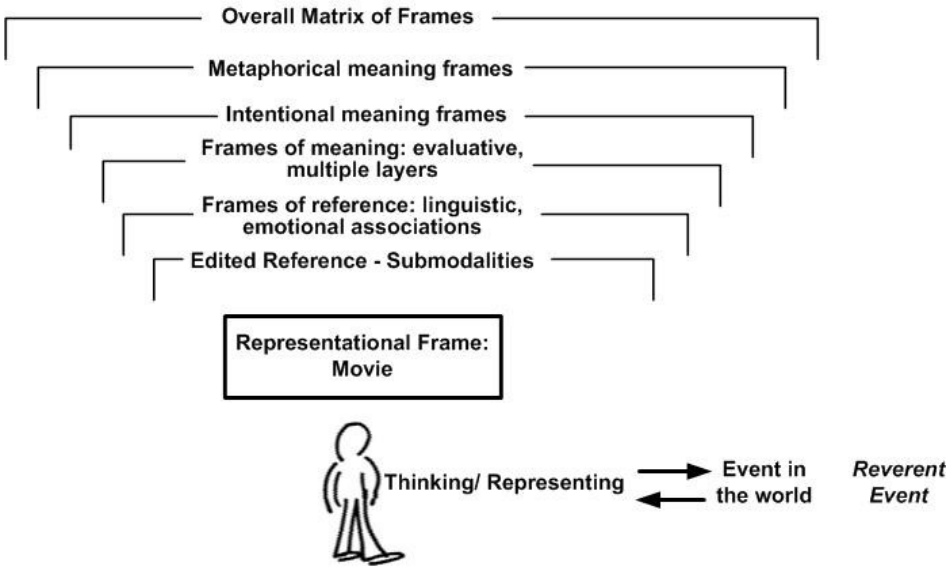
Would playfulness enrich it? Persistent? Passion? Etc.

7) Future Pace.

Will you take this into your future?

Will it enhance your life and align your attentions to your highest intentions?

Will you keep this?



PERSONAL GENIUS PATTERN

The "genius" or mastery state is a state of being totally committed and engaged so that the world goes away, your sense of self goes away, time vanishes, and your focus becomes highly intentional with a laser beam focus.

Source: The original ideas for this came from Grinder and DeLozier's *Turtles all the Way Down: Prerequisites For Personal Genius* (1987). In that work, they explored the use of "logical levels" to protect and govern a focused commitment state in that work to use a higher level to govern first-level attentions. In the following pattern, we will access a current "genius" state of total engagement and use that as a template for building up a new genius state.

Using a template of accessing a genius state: We will first access a naturally occurring "genius" state and use it as a template for the process. Doing this does several things. It creates an awareness that we already can and do access focused states of "flow" in which we get lost in an experience. It also refreshes and enriches the natural genius state. It creates a sense of self-confidence about this process.

A "genius" state involves focus, clarity, commitment, engagement, lost in the moment, at one's best with all of one's resources available, "in the zone," experiencing "flow," etc. And because such states are very focused, we have to protect them so that we don't contaminate, dilute, or reduce them. Finding your own template for how you get lost in a state enables you to recognize that personal genius is fully possible for you.

Stepping in and out of the genius state allows you to find the differences that make a difference and to use those distinctions for creating ecological boundaries. These distinctions inform your neurology for when and where to cue the state. By stepping cleanly out of the state, and shifting the focus of your mind and body system, you learn to separate from this intense *flow state* so that you can leave it cleanly behind. Do this repeatedly until you can do so impeccably . . . with no residue left over.

Practicing interrupting enables you to learn to trust yourself, to trust that you will not lose the state, to trust that you can always get it back. This then changes your relationship to the experience and to the experience of being "interrupted." This pattern involves inviting a person to be interrupted and handle it effectively by stepping out of state, handling the interruption, and then matter-of-factly stepping back into state. Begin by practicing responding to an interruption and then take charge of it by interrupting yourself so that you step out of state with a minimum overlap, and then back into the state in a moment's notice.

The brain/ nervous system will learn this pattern quickly and achieve the desire level of competency of state shifting. When you carry over no mental or emotional residue from one state to the other, but cleanly separates and breaks between them and can then step back in and re-access that state with a strong intensity, you are making an impeccable state shift.

Distinctions:

- The genius pattern structures the levels of our mind so we can focus attention on one engagement and be all there.

- When we double or multi-track, we are not all there.

Elicitation Questions:

- Where are you completely present so that time goes away, the world goes away, and you get lost in some engagement?
- Where would you like to experience that kind of presence and focus?

Creating a New Genius Pattern

In the following the "genius" state is called an *engagement* state, *flow, in the zone, a commitment state.* All of these are synonyms.

1) Access the new desired focus state.

What focus or engagement state do you want to build? What do you call that state?
Where do you want this state of full engagement? When?
Have you ever had a little bit of it? [Yes] Good. Access that bit seeing what you saw, hearing what you heard, and feeling what you felt. Go there and *be with it* fully. Do you need to amplify this state?

2) Access a simple state of innocent witnessing and/or observing.

Step out of that state. Let's access a discreet state of "just observing." Step into this position and just notice some of the colors and sounds, etc. in the room. Are all of your muscles relaxed so that you are just observing?

3) Practice stepping in and out to develop impeccable state shifting.

Step back into the desired genius state and be there as fully as possible. How much are you in this state? Tell me what it is like? Posture, breathing, perspective, etc.
Step out again. How much of that state did you bring with you?
Repeatedly step in and out of this new genius state, practicing a clean state shift. Do this to make distinctions in your neurology which will allow you to know how to have it upon cue. Contrast the two states— posture, muscle tension, face, breath, internal dialogue, etc.
Step back in. Let's set up a sphere that will protect your genius state. When you step out, take a moment to snapshot where you are— what you are seeing, hearing, saying, doing. Then step out.,
Step out again until you can do so cleanly, leaving the genius state intact. Take as little of it as possible. Ready, go. Step out to your observer position.
Would you like to imagine a bubble that protects and secures this genius state? (You could use a wall, a door, the Stargate picture of liquid space, etc.)

4) Use your executive mind to further develop the genius state.

Step back in. There's a part of your mind that makes decisions, that decides when and where to have this genius state. As you are in this state, let that part of your mind rise up from the focused state to an executive level state. This is the state that will be able to take charge of things when you are fully engaged in this state. Would you like that?

Would you like this executive level of mind to run the choices you make so that you can be cued about when the appropriateness of staying in this state or coming out? Would you

like your executive mind to determine when to make the switch in and out of the flow or genius state and to determine the contexts for the boundaries of this state?

Re-access the state and then rise up in your mind to the part of your mind that makes decisions and answer the following questions. [The experiencer does *not* need to speak the answers, but simply nod when he or she has an answer.]

World:
Place: Where should you have this state? Where not?
Contexts: In what context or contexts? In what contexts should you not?
Time*:* When should you have this state? When should you not?
Intention:
Criteria: According to what other criteria and qualities?
Value: Why should you have this state? How would it be valuable to you?
Emergencies: For what will you be interrupted? What emergencies will you allow to bring you out?
Power:
Style: How should you? In what way, with what style? How should you not?
Resources: What other resources would you like to add to this state that would even more fully express the quality and efficiency that you want? Any other resources to add to the genius state? Love, respect, daring, fallibility, balance, etc.?
Others: *Relationship:* With whom? With whom not?
Meaning:
Meanings: For what significance or meaning? What meanings to not give it?
Reasons: Why should you? Your reasons, agendas, motivations? Why should you not?
Any other considerations that you would like to determine the boundaries of this engagement state?

5) Commission the executive meta-state.
[The person still in the state] "The part of your mind that makes decisions—are you willing to take full responsibility for setting these parameters for this commitment state so that this person [say his or her name] can fully experience this commitment state? [Yes!]
Are you willing to take responsibility for letting this person fully experience this intense and passionate state? For knowing the limits and boundaries, when to have it and when not, how to have it and how not, will you signal X when to step out?

6) Future pace to install*.*
As you imagine moving out into your future, are you fully aligned with this? Any objections?

Troubleshooting: The following is only used when a person does *not* think he can access a "genius" state.

Previous Genius Template State

1) Access a state of innocent witnessing and/or observing.

Access a pure and discreet state of "just observing." Step into this position and just notice some of the colors and sounds, etc. of this room.
Have you ever stepped back from something and just observed things?
Are all of your muscles relaxed so that you are just observing?

2) Identify a fully committed state wherein you can "get lost" in the state

Take a moment to think back over your history and, has there ever been a time when you were in a committed state? What was that like? Have you ever been committed to something else? Find a specific state that you have fairly easy access to and which you can elicit fully. Choose a state that comes as close to a full 100% commitment as possible.

3) Access the focus state fully

- What do you call this commitment state?
- As you recall a time when you were really into this state, step into it fully, seeing what you saw, hearing what you heard, and feeling what you felt. Just be there fully and completely. Describe it until you refresh it and it amplifies. When you have fully accessed this state to a level of 8 or 9 on a scale of 10, nod to let me know or say so.

4) Practice stepping in and out of the state to develop impeccable state shifting

- In just a moment I want you to step out of these state fully and cleanly, leaving this state intact and as you step out, taking as little of it as possible. Okay? So ready, go. Step out to your observer position.
- Would you like to imagine a bubble that protects and secures this genius state?

5) Access an executive level of mind wherein you make decisions

- There's a part of your mind that makes decisions, that decides when and where to have this genius state. Rise up from the focused state to this executive level state that it can take charge of things while you get lost in this state. Would you like that?
- Would you like this executive level of mind to run the choices you make so that you can be cued about when the appropriateness of staying in this state or coming out? Would you like your executive mind to determine when to make the switch in and out of the genius states and to determine the contexts for the "cage" or Boundaries of your genius state?
- Good. Then just inside your mind, answer the following questions:
  - *Time:* When should you have this state? When should you not?
  - *Place:* Where should you have this state? Where not?
  - *Style:* How should you? In what way, with what style? How should you not?

- *Criteria:* According to what other criteria and qualities?
- *Contexts:* In what context or contexts? In what contexts should you not?
- *Intention:* Why should you? Your reasons, agendas, motivations? Why should you not?
- *Relational:* With whom? With whom not?
- *Meaning:* For what significance or meaning? What meanings to not give it?
- *Resources:* What other characteristics and features could you add to this state that would even more fully express the quality and efficiency that you want? Any other resources to add to the genius state? love, respect, daring, fallibility, balance, etc.?
- *Emergencies, Interruptions:* For what emergencies or concerns will you step out and interrupt this genius state?
- Any other considerations that you would like to determine the boundaries of this genius state?

6) Commission the executive meta-state and future pace

- Are you willing to take full responsibility for setting these parameters for this commitment state so that this person can fully experience this commitment state? [Yes!]
- Are you willing to take responsibility for letting this person fully experience this intense and passionate state? For knowing the limits and boundaries, when to have it and when not, how to have it and how not, will you signal X when to step out?
- As you imagine moving out into your future, are you fully aligned with this? Any objections?

EXCUSE BLOW-OUT PATTERN

To use the emotionally intelligence that meta-stating creates as you access your own mastery, you need to learn how to *refuse* excuses, refuse to allow excuses to dominate your life. When excuses dominate, you are essentially choosing your excuses over your values and visions. Think about that! You are excusing yourself from excellence and expertise.

There's a logical level of the mind of explanations (reasons, understandings). You can use your reasoning and explanations both to recognize legitimate constrains that you have to deal with and illegitimate, stupid, and useless excuses. Most excuses simply waste time, sabotage goals, and undermine effectiveness. With this pattern, learn to refuse to sell yourself short as you flush out excuses from your reasoning.

Distinctions:

- When we confuse our excuses with explanations and reasons, we excuse ourselves from excellence and from going after our dreams.
- Distinguish legitimate reasons from illegitimate reasons; the latter are *excuses.*
- Map out with the person his or her sense of "time" kinesthetically on the floor. Use a goal that will require between one and three months.

Elicitation Questions:

- How do you excuse yourself from taking the necessary actions required for reaching your highest goals and achieving your best dreams?
- The more intelligent a person, the more elaborate excuses he can invent.
- Excuses are usually driven by thinking short-term rather than holding the vision of what we really want.

The Pattern:

1) Access a desired outcome

"Here you are today, what do you want to achieve that's very important to you that will take 2 or 3 months to achieve?" State it in the positive. What will you see, or hear, or sense kinesthetically?

Is this outcome something you can initiate and continue? It is in your power?

Let's walk out on a time-line to 2 or 3 months... Here you get want you want— is it compelling? How much? Now let's walk backward — back to the present. At today — do you still find your goal compelling?

2) Let the excuse or excuses emerge

Imagine stepping forward and taking action in your life to reach your goal—as you imagine carrying out those actions, do any objections or excuses arise? Anything stopping you? If yes, stop, notice, identify—what is the excuse? What are you saying to yourself? Feel the excuse to notice where you feel it in your body. What does it feel like? Where? How do you know to call it an excuse?

3) Quality control the excuse

Is it just an excuse? [If **no**, then move to step 4, if **yes**, ask:] Do you want this excuse? Do you need it?

Does it serve your life at all? Does it enhance you or empower you?
If there is some part of the excuse that you might need or want to preserve, what is it?
Is there any value in the excuse?

4) Preserve the excuse's values and benefits

What is the value that is in the excuse that you want to keep? Specify.
Take that value, separate it from the excuse and preserve it. Take out any value, belief, or understanding that's useful. Remove it so that the excuse is now an empty shell, devoid of any usefulness at all.
With the value—the reason or understanding that you want to keep with you. Store it away as a value to appreciate.
[Checking where things are:] Is it now just an excuse? Just an empty shell of an excuse?
[Yes] If not, repeat until you just have an empty shell of an excuse left.
Or has the excuse just vanished away? Dissolved?

5) Step back to Choice Point.

Now that you know it is *just an excuse,* what will you now do? Which will you say YES to? Which will you say NO to? What will you do?

6) Reject the empty shell of the old worn out excuse

Access a strong *"No!"* state, a *"Hell, No!"* state. Amplify that state of "rejection, refusal, or disgust" that comes out as a *"No"* fully until you feel it very strongly. As you feel it in your hands and in your feet, let it radiate throughout your body.
When you have it accessed very strongly, imagine the empty excuse immediately in front of you and step into that excuse with the No!" state and stomp on the excuse with the power of your "hell, No!" Stomp it to the ground.
Have you fully and completely stood your ground and stubbornly refused the excuse?
Will it stop you anymore from reaching your goal?

7) Test

Now imagine the desired activity that's ecological and notice what happens as you think about moving toward it ...
What do you feel? What comes to mind?
Do you have any excuse lurking that you might use to excuse yourself from life, love, and commitment?
Can anything stop you now?

8) Access your executive decision state

Will you do this? Will you take all of the necessary steps to reach your goal?
Will you allow it to become an attractor in your mind so that as you think of this activity, how you will do it will simply become a matter of discovery and of building the resources so that you can .. and will. will you not?
Will you keep it?

SPINNING ICONS

You have been meta-stating mostly with language, not for some *non-languaging* meta-states. Spinning Icons is an *outside*-of-consciousness pattern that uses non-propositional language rather than explicit language that proposes understandings. Use this pattern for creating more personal integration when someone has internal parts that conflict with each other. It will enable you to transform internal generalizations (e.g., beliefs, ideas, understandings, decisions, etc.) which conflict and torment you into a new resource for personal congruence. Use it to create a new integrated and synthesized generalization as a new and more resourceful map.

Source: This comes from the work of Nelson Zink and Joe Munshaw (*NLP World*, Nov. 1996). For full description, see *Meta-States Magic* (2001). It introduces meta-states into the old Collapsing of Parts Pattern.

Distinctions:

- If we feel inwardly torn between two great choices, we will not be able to fully access our genius state of full presence.
- We don't have to consciously understand for a process to create a better alignment between our conflicting parts.

Elicitation Questions:

- Do you have two parts pulling away at you? Work and relaxation?
- Are you ready to let your larger mind resolve an inner conflict that you haven't been able to resolve with your conscious mind?
- Are you ready to stop trying to figure it out and just experience a possible solution that you may or may not understand?
- Are you also ready to let yourself go into a spin and loosen up old frames?

The Pattern:

1) Access two primary states or experiences that internally feel at odds.

What two ideas, understandings, beliefs feel at odds within you and that creates conflict for you?

What parts do you not have peace about?

Menu List: Perhaps the ideal that "it's bad to be materialistic," and "the desire to succeed in life and win lots of toys." Perhaps, "I can't stand criticism," and "To stand out from the crowd and take risks involves exposing myself to criticism."

If we imagine this state or experience in one of your hands, which hand would you want for this one? And the other in your other hand.

2) Turn the primary states into abstract symbols.

Just in your mind, step back and go meta to this first state or experience and let the creative part of your mind generate an iconic image, cartoon, or symbol of it... Let it emerge in this hand. That's right.

Now do the same with this second state or experience.

3) At a meta level to the two iconic images, let the two images slowly exchange locations.

I would now like you to imagine that this image in this hand . . . exchanges places with that image in the other hand . . . Just let that happen now.
And let's do that again. Mentally let the two icons or images exchange places one more time. Put "materialism" in the location of "desire to succeed" and vise versa.
Good, now lets them continue to exchange places and let the exchange move faster and faster . . . that's right . . . and do so until they become to blend together . . . until a synthesis emerge from them . . . Round and round they go . . .

4) Rise up from this single image or icon and let a story emerge.

Now, in your mind, rise up above this new emergent synthesis of the two images that have merged together and mixed and just, stop and begin to tell a story about this new mixture. You can make up a proverb if you like about it, or sing a song, or invent a poem, express a motto, koan, or even get up and dance what the icon means to you.
What is this synthesis of the merging parts like?
If you don't know *what* to say, this is actually better because it allows you to just let your other-than-conscious mind to invent it on the spot... so just begin speaking, the quicker the better. Without hesitating, just begin now.

5) Future pace and integrate.

I wonder now if you now have any new insights about the old difficulty given this new synthesis and/or story? What are you experiencing?
Would you like to take this with you into your future?
Where would you like to store it . . . inside yourself or outside in your personal space?
As you bring that in . . . just enjoy it and without needing to explain it or put things into words, just wonder ... really wonder ... at how this will make a difference in the days and weeks to come.

META-ALIGNMENT

This pattern provides a way to align and use meta-level structures to create an overall sense (gestalt) of integration, congruency, wholeness, and well-being. Run this pattern by standing and talking about each level or spatially anchor each level by back up from the primary state behavior. If you spatially anchored each meta-state, go back to the highest level of metaphor and step from there to the next one and the next gathering up the resources and bring it down to the behavior. Repeat three times until it flows as a walk of integration.

Source: I adapted this from Dilts' Neuro-logical levels in which the first three distinctions are primary state variables (behavior, environment, and capability) and the next four are actually meta-levels (beliefs, values, mission, and spirit).

Distinctions:

- Around any behavior we have multiple layers of frames of mind and meaning and they may not be aligned with the new or improved behavior.
- We can access layers of frames that support greater resourcefulness.

Elicitation Questions:

- What activity do you engage in that's very important to you, but which sometimes lacks the full range of congruency, power, and focus that you would like to have?
- Is there any behavior that you would like to perform with more personal alignment, congruency, and integrity?
- Are you *aligned* in all of your higher levels of thinking and emoting regarding a given task?

The Pattern:

1) Identify a primary state sensory-based experience wherein you want more alignment

[A set of questions to use to elicit the primary activity.]

What behavior would you like to perform with more personal alignment, congruency, and integrity? How do you know it's not as aligned as it could be?
What activity do you engage in that's very important to you but which sometimes lacks the full range of congruency, power, and focus that you would like to have?
Describe this behavior, activity, experience in sensory-based terms. Describe from a video-camera perspective. (Behavior)
Where do you do this? (Environment) Where not? When? When not?

***2) Identify the primary state mental-emotional skills and abilities which enable you to do this* (Capability)**

How do you know *how to* do this? Can you pull this off?
How do you do that? Describe it for me briefly.
What strategy or strategies do you deploy in doing this?

***3) Identify the meta-levels of beliefs that support and empower this* (Beliefs)**

What do you believe about that?
What belief supports you doing that?
What are some empowering beliefs that support this behavior?

4) Identify the Values that support this **(Values)**

Why do you engage in this?
Why do you believe this is important?
What are some empowering values that support this behavior?

5) Identify the meta-state of identity which emerges for you **(Identity)**

When you do this, does it affect your identity? Who are you when you engage in this?
What does engaging in this behavior say about your identity?

6) Identify the meta-state of purpose and destiny that then arises **(Vision, Mission, Spirit)**

Does this fit into your overall sense of destiny and purpose? How does it?
What's your highest intentions in doing this?

7) Identify the decision that supports this.

Have you decided to do this? You will?
You have said "Yes!" to this?
What decision supports this behavior?

8) Describe these meta-levels of meaning with a metaphor or story.

What is this like? Let a metaphor or story encapsulate this matrix of your mind.
As it emerges ...notice its sounds, colors, shapes, music, light, etc.

9) Bring the higher levels down to the primary state behavior to let it all integrate

Now ... let's walk through the steps to confirm them and let you *feel* them fully.

[Walk from the Metaphor up to the Behavior; hold anchor on person's arm.]

Again, let's back up through the steps.

[Walk backwards from Behavior to Beliefs, Values, etc. back to Metaphor.]

Now follow my lead as I do this . . . .

[Quickly walk up through the spatial anchors to the belief . . . .]

And with all of that in mind — just enjoy thinking about this behavior and feeling it with all of the awarenesses that you created . . . and imagine bringing all of that into this experience and letting all of your meta-levels enrich it. And how's that? Do you like that? Do you now feel fully aligned in this activity? Let them even more fully coalesce into this behavior to give it the quality and richness that you want. And how do you now experience this behavior? You want to keep this? Will you?

HERE'S TO YOUR PERSONAL GENIUS!

Now that you have meta-stated yourself with many resources, many prerequisites of genius, you are ready to begin using specific flow state or genius states for developing personal mastery in the areas that you desire. If you have *fully experienced* the meta-stating processes in the 14 patterns, you are well on your way to habitualizing it as a meta-skill.

You have meta-stated yourself 21 times in 14 patterns:

–1– *(1) Awareness* for mindfulness.
(2) Ownership for response-ableness and proactivity.

–2– *(3) Acceptance* for self-acceptance.
(4) Appreciation for self-appreciation of your gifts and talents.
(5) Awe and esteem for self-worth and esteem to get your ego out of the way.

–3– *(6) Dis-validation* for saying No to everything that interferes or undermines your effectiveness and for setting up boundaries.
(7) Validation for saying Yes to everything worthwhile and for transforming mere thoughts into nervous-system commanding "beliefs."

–4– *(8) Pleasure* for enjoying this moment and every engagement you give yourself to.
(9) *De-pleasuring, the limiting* of value/ meaning that semantically loads something.

–5– (10) *Acknowledge* and *(11) permission* of emotions as "just emotions" to welcome all emotions.

–6– *(12) Exploration* of our matrix of frames to see what conceptual worlds we live in;
(13) Stepping back to choice point to *(14) Quality Control* a matrix.

–7– *(14) Analyzing* unresourceful states for *transformational power* to dance with our energies and coordinate them for mastery (Dancing with Dragons).

–8– *(15) Feedforward* information as energy to close the knowing-doing gap and get our greatest ideas and principles into muscle-memory.

–9– *(16) Possibility* thinking and imagining to tap our creativity for thinking outside the box and accessing the wonder and curiosity of what's possible.

–10– *(17) Intentionality* to access our highest values and to get a big enough *why* to handle any and every *how* of life.

–11– *(18) Setting boundaries* at the executive level to set all of the necessary frames for stepping into and out of flow at will. (Accessing Personal Genius)

–12– *(19) Distinguishing* legitimate and illegitimate reasons and explanations to blow-out all excuses while considering reality constraints to be dealt with.

–13– *(20) Using disequilibrium* to resolve issues and conflict that our current thinking may be unable to resolve. (Spinning Icons)

–14– *(21) Alignment* to apply the full force of our integrity and congruency to the thing we do.

With all of that in mind and body, you're off to a good start in developing a focused mastery and discipline. May you now fully embrace all of the higher powers of your self-reflexive consciousness and create a dozen wonderful genius states for your health, relationships, visions, values, and career!

FINER DETAILS OF THE META-STATES MODEL

META-STATING EFFECTS

Some of the wild and crazy interactions that result from a state-upon-state structure**.** In a neuro-linguistic system, all kinds of things happen when we meta-state. A wide-range of new responses and consequences can arise. What do you want to do? What can you expect? [@ stands for "about"]

1) Reduce Painfully States. Some meta-states will reduce the primary state:

Calm about anger — Playfully belligerent
Thoughtfully fearful — Experiencing pleasant tension

2) Intensify Or Magnify States. Some meta-states will amplify and turn up the primary state:

Worry about worry — Loving love
Loving learning — Unruffled resolution
Anxious about anxiety (hyper-anxiety)
Calm about calm — Belligerent Playfulness
Passionate about learning — Compulsive @ being compulsive
Appreciate the state of appreciation — Boundless Joy

3) Exaggerate and Distort States. This increases the intensity factor. Generally, when we bring a negative state of thoughts-feelings to bear on another state, we *turn our psychic energies against ourselves*.

Anger about anger — Defiant Courage
Love hatred of— — Fear about fear
Hesitating to hesitate (talk non-fluently) creates stuttering
Sadness about sadness (depression) — Mistrust of mistrust (PS: accurate)

4) Negate or Neutralize a State (so that a level collapses)

In doubt about my doubt, I usually feel more sure.
Resisting your own resistance — Flexibly compulsive
In procrastinating my procrastination, I take action and put off the putting off.
Mistrusting mistrust
Ashamed of Shame — Impervious to being offended

5) Interrupt States. It so jars and shifts the first state, it totally interrupts it. It can arrest the psycho-logic:

Humorous about serious — Intentionally panicking
Anxious about calmness — Calmness about anxiety

6) Confuse States. By getting various thoughts-feelings to collide and "fuse" "with" each other in ways that we do not comprehend. Ridiculous about Serious

7) Contradict at Different Levels to Create Paradox. By shifting experience to a higher and different level; it explains powerful techniques as "paradoxical intention" Watzlawick (1984): "Kant recognized that every error of this kind [map/territory confusion error] consists in our taking the way we determine, divide, or deduce concepts for qualities of the things in and of themselves" (215). Bateson defined paradox as a contradiction in conclusions that one correctly argued from consistent premises.

The "Be spontaneous now!" paradox. — Try really hard to Relax
"Never say never"
"Never and always are two words one should always remember never to use."
"I'm absolutely certain that nothing is absolutely certain."
Title of book: *"This Book Needs No Title."* (Raymond M. Smallya, 1980)

8) Dissociate from Strong Feelings. Whenever we *step out* from one state, we *associate* or step into another. We are never *state-less!* Sometimes in meta-stating, we experience a sense of "dissociation" in the sense of feeling not-in-our-body, merely spectating, apart, strange, etc. If we dissociate dramatically enough, it may

result in amnesia (switching states rapidly and without reference frequently produces amnesia and other trance phenomena).

Sense of pain being over there — Spectating about anxiety
Observing old trauma — Ecology-checking value of resentment
Have the ringing in your ears but tune it down until you don't quite hear it anymore

9) Seed A New Process/ Create Response Potential. Can get us to *initiate* the first step of a new experience, create a *new emergent experience:*

Courage to have courage — Playful uncertainty
Learning how to learn — Gentle anger — Willing to become willing

10) Grab and Focus Attention/ Swish mind to provoke thoughtfulness in a different direction. As such it can arrest attention, overload consciousness, stimulate new thinking, and question axioms, beliefs, reasoning, memory, etc. (hence deframe). Calm about Anger — Appreciative about Anger
Lovingly Gentle about Anger — Resistance of Resistance

11) Entrance & Hypnotize. Create trance phenomena. Most people experience third-order abstracting and above as "trancy." It invites one to "go inside" so much that the "inward focus" of trance develops as one engages, consciously and unconsciously, in an internal search for meaning. We especially experience meta-stating that shifts logical types *and* sets up double-binds as initiating trance.

Rebel against thinking about just how comfortable you can feel if you don't close your eyes before you're ready to relax deeper than you ever have before, now.
I wonder if you're going to fail to succeed at not going into trance at exactly your own speed or whether you won't.

12) Gestalt Experiences to generate Gestalt States and Phenomena. States-about-states frequently generates gestalt experiences so that something new emerges from the process that we cannot explain as a summation of the parts, it partakes of a systemic and non-additivity quality.

Suppress Excitement — Anxiety — Worry @ what X means — Existential Concern
We experience our experiences— Self-Awareness, Consciousness

13) Jar Consciousness to Create Humor. The jolt and jar of state-upon-state often results in the gestalt of humor (Plato: that which we experience as "out of place in time and space without danger"). It tickles our fancy, delights our consciousness, surprises, amazes, shocks, etc.

14) Qualify, Temper, and Add Texture to States and Experiences. The higher level state *qualifies* the lower level experience inasmuch as it *sets the frame* for the primary experience.

Joyful learning — An accomplished liar — Devious negotiation
Boring learning — A charming lie — Ruthless compassion
Cleverly courageous — Courageously Clever — Unspeakable Peace
Flexible compulsiveness — Strict Standards

15) Solidify a State or Level.

To set up a frame that will solidify, and make permanent and solid the underlying experience.
Believe or value in X — Take pride in X
Belief in your belief about X — Pride of depression
Proud of jealousy — Identify with X (make it your identity)

(16) Loosen States, Frames, and Realities

Doubt X — Question X — Be playful about X

DISTINGUISHING BETWEEN PRIMARY & META-STATES

PRIMARY STATES	META-STATES
*** Simple/Direct**	**Complex/Indirect**
First-Level	Second/Third Levels, etc., many layers of consciousness
Immediate, automatic	**Layer** levels of consciousness/Mediated by symbols
Synesthesia (V—K)	Meta-level synesthesias—the Coalescing of Levels
*** Primary Kinesthetics**	**Meta-kinesthetics or "emotions"/ Evaluative Emotions**
(primary emotions)	—judgments coded in the soma (body)
Modality & Sbmd. driven	**Linguistically-Driven**
Kinesthetically Exper. +/-	Less Immediate or localized K +/-
Associated	"Dissociated" from primary emotions; *associated* into MS
Easily Anchored	Chains of Anchors—glued together by words
Intense to very intense	Less intense, more thoughtful, can be *more* intense.
Strong, primitive, deep	Weaker, less primitive, more modified by cognition
Quicker, Shorter	Lasts Longer, more enduring, stable
Animal	Human: dependent upon symbol-using capacities
One time learning	One time learning very infrequent
	Repetition generally **needed** to drive in & install
*** 1st. Position**	**2nd., 3rd. or other multiple positions**
	consciousness expanded & transcendental
Thought @ world	Thoughtfulness/ Mindfulness, Thought @ Thought
*** Object: external -in world**	**Object: internal — in mind-emotions**
*** Sensory-Based Linguistics**	**Evaluative Based Linguistics**
Empirical Qualities	Emergent Qualities/properties:
	Having no lower-order counterparts
Somewhat projective	Highly projective
	Once Coalesced— begins to operate as a Primary
*** Thresholds**	**The lack of Thresholds**
Has natural limits	Higher levels & states can get one to push beyond
Sensory-based nature	natural primary level limits
of pleasures	

How To Effectively Distinguish Meta-States and Primary States:

1) *Appropriate.*
   Is this response appropriate to the stimuli offered? Is this response directly or indirectly connected to it?
2) *Emotion.*
   What is the nature of the emotion involved, kinesthetic or conceptual? An emotion of the body or of the mind?
3) *Aboutness.*
   What is the object of this state? Something "out there" or something "in here?"
4) *Language.*
   What kind of language describes this? Sensory based language or evaluative based terms?
5) *Perceptual Position*.
   Which perceptual position seems to organize this state?

META-LEVEL PRINCIPLES

Similar to the *presuppositions* that we have in NLP about its assumptive frames, we have a set of presuppositions (or principles, laws, secrets) about the logic of *the meta-levels.* Welcome to the Logic of Meta-Land.

1) *Higher logical levels drive, modulate, organize, and control lower levels.*

The foremost of the meta-level principles describes the dynamic formulated by Gregory Bateson (1972). This identifies that meta-levels serve as *the frame-of-reference* for the activity (thinking, feeling, responding) that occurs at the levels lower to the frame. As such, the meta-level operates as an "attractor" in a self-organizing system. Robert Dilts (1990) has described this as part of the definition of logical levels.

Whenever we "set a frame of reference" at a higher logical level that frame will dominate all lower levels. The Interface between higher and lower levels generates a whole list of effects: from intensifying the lower states, defusing them, negating them, multiplying them, creating trance, creating paradox, etc.

2) Someone will always set the frame of reference.

The question now becomes, *"Who* set the frame?" Sometimes the frame occurs by "osmosis" in that we simply *breathe and live in* it as the cultural, linguistic, familial, professional, etc. frame. Marshal McLuhen noted that while he didn't know who first noticed and specified "water" as such, he knew it wasn't the fish. This speaks about the *unconscious nature* of meta-levels. They exist *above* normal conscious awareness— and so we just assume them. Count on your M-S becoming your unconscious frames— your "way of being in the world," your *attitude.*

3) Whoever sets the frame will govern the experience (run the game!).

Since higher frames govern—and since somebody also sets it (no need to allow Lost Performatives here!), the person who sets the frame thereby takes charge of the subsequent experiences. The resulting thoughts, ideas, concepts, beliefs, emotions, behaviors, language, problems, solutions, and experiences derive their existence from the frame. *Frames govern.*

4) The whole determines the parts and emerges from the parts.

This speaks about the systemic nature of the mind-body system. It speaks about the *gestalt* nature of our neuro-linguistics processes. The system that emerges from the meta-levels that govern the lower levels brings about an overall gestalt (or configuration of interactive parts) which in turn, define the character of the whole.

5) When we outframe we set up higher level frames-of-reference that we commission to govern the whole.

The power to identify a frame enables us to step aside from a frame and to set a whole new frame. Doing this transforms everything. It performs meta-level "magic" in that it installs a new self-organizing attractor at the top of the semantic system.

6) What we call "experience" or "reality" differs radically at each level.

Korzybski (1933/1994) described these in his "levels of abstraction" model regarding how the nervous system *abstracts* at different levels. He described the different experiences as "second-order abstractions," "third-order abstractions," etc. He described the fact that we can use the same word/s at the different levels as *multiordinal terms* —terms that have no specific meaning until we specify at which level we refer. Thus "love" of an object at the primary level differs from "love of love" (infatuation) at the second level or "love of anger," and "love of loving love" at the third level (romanticism perhaps), etc.

7) Reflexivity gives consciousness its systemic nature and characteristics.

Reflexivity describes the mechanism that drives these levels of abstraction and these meta-level experience. This refers to the fact that our consciousness can *reflect back* onto itself or its products (thoughts, emotions, beliefs, values, decisions, specific concepts, etc.). As it does, it sets up feed-back and feed-forward processes and thereby creates a circular system.

8) Meta-level disorientation and conflict can create living hells.

Generally speaking (numerous exceptions do exist), whenever we bring *negative* thoughts-and-feelings (states) against ourselves or any facet of ourselves, we put ourselves at odds with ourselves. And when our self-relationships (relation to ourselves) become disturbed, we begin to loop around in vicious downward self-reinforcing cycles. And when self-disturbed (self-condemning, self-contempting, self-repressing, self-hating, etc.), this then creates a disturbance for all of our relationships with others. This creates neurosis, psychosis, personality disorders, character disorders, etc.

9) "Paradox" governs meta-level solutions for health, integration, balance, and empowerment.

The only way to rid ourselves of unwanted thoughts, emotions, behaviors, habits, etc. involves, *paradoxically,* welcoming, accepting, appreciating, and celebrating that very thought, emotion, behavior, etc. By welcoming it into consciousness we can take counsel of it, reality check it, learn from it, etc. To *not* reckon with it leads to unuseful suppression, repression, self-rejection, etc.

10) Setting a frame necessitates neuro-linguistic energy and repetition.

How do we actually *set* a frame or establish a meta-level State? Merely "thinking" or even "feeling" will not do it. We can think, know, feel, and have awarenesses that do *not establish* a higher level frame-of-reference. We can "think" without believing, valuing, and deciding. Here we need to utilize the natural processes of how our brains operate — we need to use drama, energy, repetition, etc.

11) Altering higher level frames alters identity and destiny.

You can't change what you *do* (so that it lasts in a pervasive and generative way), without also changing *who you are.* Does your higher frame of self-definition support the change? Your behavior is like a printout of your Operating Programs.

12) Meta-Levels never stay "meta" for long but coalesce into the primary state.

While we "conceptually" move up to a higher level and layer our mind with additional thoughts, they will not stay there for long. With repetition, habituation brings them back down into the flesh, the muscle, the eyes. This explains how meta-states become our Meta-Programs and how the "sub-modality" distinctions code and recode our representations.

13) The sequencing of meta-levels are critical.

There is a structure to the higher levels of consciousness, and the order and sequencing of what layers of thoughts-and-emotions we meta-state ourselves with determines the quality of our states.

14) The quality of our states are textured by the higher levels.

The higher levels percolate down into the lower levels.

APG represents training in NLP's fourth *meta-domain*. *Meta-States* enables us to discover how we create and change our *Meta-Programs,* how *the Meta-Model* gives us a way of handling the meta-representational system of language that encodes meta-states. *Meta-States* ties together so many of the individual domains in NLP providing an over-arching framework for all of the meta-phenomena, from "beliefs," "values," "sub-modalities," "identity," etc. It will also introduce you to the many, many *other* "logical levels."

PREREQUISITES OF PERSONAL GENIUS

- Do you know the characteristics of "genius" that you will need to develop?
- Do you know *how* to go about the process of accessing and developing the prerequisites of personal genius?
- Would you like to access and develop your own personal genius?

Meta-Stating to Access and Develop Personal Genius
This training in NLP and Meta-States utilizes the various characteristics of genius cumulatively build each piece and layer them one upon the other. If there is *structure* to experience, then identifying that structure and replicating it gives us a pathway to excellence. That's what we do in this training. We use the NLP and Meta-States models to access, amplify, and apply the individual components that make up the larger gestalt that we call "genius." In this way, we make genius accessible.

Using both description and then experiential exercises or games, the training walks a person through the process for creating the resourceful states and frames that support personal development.

What are the distinctions of genius? These are the features or components that enter into the mix that makes for operating with a laser beam focus and concentration, with passion and commitment, without internal conflicts and stress, with being able to fully step into a state of being of one mind about something.

A healthy genius has a unique balance of being able to notice specific detailing awareness in his or her field. Such a person can see, hear, or feel salient differences that others miss. Genius involves the ability to make distinctions, to see, hear and feel what others do not, to sort and separate what others confuse.

This particular focus also requires higher frames that governs *what* and *how* we do this. At higher (or *meta)* levels, our governing frame looks for similarities. Genius sees, hears, and feels *patterns*—the patterns that connect, the patterns that formulate schemas that give structure to the details, the patterns that discover leverage points within systems. In this, genius involves *a balance* and *integration* of numerous things. It involves the wisdom of multiple perceptual positions, and supporting Meta-States which support this kind of internal structure.

To Get Your Neuro-Linguistics on Your Side
began as John Grinder and Richard Bandler modeled the expertise of three therapeutic geniuses, Virginia Satir, Fritz Perls, and Milton Erickson. What they found in three very distinct disciplines (Family Systems Therapy, Gestalt Therapy, and Ericksonian Hypnosis) became the foundational principles (presuppositions) and patterns for NLP. In the beginning they created NLP to function as a communication model, that is, a model about how we use our brains and nervous systems to "process" and encode information which thereby creates our mental maps and formats our skills and abilities of navigation.

This led Grinder and Bandler to describe NLP as essentially a model about "how to run your own brain." Yet it was more. As Dilts formulated the Strategy Model for modeling and began modeling geniuses (Freud, Aristotle, Einstein, Disney, etc.), the field of NLP began to become much more focused on generative models that would enable people to replicate genius. Co-founders, Grinder and Judith DeLozier then turned their attention to what they called *the prerequisites of genius.* They detailed this in the book, *Turtles All the Way Down* (1987). In doing so they came up with such descriptions as the following for *genius:*

- Intense focus or concentration (a state of "flow")
- Single tracking or first-level attention focus

- Multiple perspectives that gives one "wisdom" of the whole
- Development of commitment states
- Clean state accessing and shifting in and out of the commitment states, "impeccable state shifting"
- Crystal clarity of purpose and direction

Logical Levels and Developing "Genius"
In their work, Grinder and DeLozier quoted Bateson extensively and described the shift in consciousness from double-tracking to single-attention tracking. Further, they said that such a state of mind could only be controlled by the use of "logical levels." To do that, they developed a process for commissioning a "Controller" state at a higher logical level to guide and guard the genius state.

Unknowingly, they thereby used a meta-stating process and structure. If they had known that, the training would not have taken seven days, but half a day as we commonly do in Meta-States Training. It has only be with the development of *the Meta-States model* that now allows us to work more explicitly and therefore effectively with the *levels* of mind. Now, with Meta-States, we can access our higher executive states of mind to establish the kind of frames of reference that bring out our personal genius.

"Genius" as *the enhanced ability to make highly refined distinctions* within and about the qualities, features, and properties of the sensory representation systems of "thought" while simultaneously making appropriate and empowering frames-of-references and meta-frames now becomes more possible for us. This description, in fact, suggests a two-fold focus for a "genius." Namely, a distinguishing detailed awareness which knows how to specify the key differences.
This now allows us to add several additional distinctions or prerequisites of genius. Namely:

- Congruency and personal alignment with our values and beliefs
- Empowering decisions for focus and clarity
- High level state management skills for stepping in and out of states of "flow"
- Modeling meta-states like resilience, un-insultability using meta-frames to protect one's "genius."
- Resilience: letting nothing get you down. Using negative results as positive feedback about how to proceed in a smart way.
- Synergizing with others who will become a friend to your genius

Meta-Stating the Characteristics
1) *Passionate Focus.* We begin with passion, a clearly focused passion, something that we really care about. We do so by accessing a state of passion about something by thinking about something that we really love or care about, something that we find compelling and inescapable. This makes it easy to become of one mind about that thing, to enter into "the demon" state (to use Grinder's terminology). This induces us into a commitment state wherein we feel passionate and can move into a first level attention focus. This creates a powerfully positive "flow" state where a sense of time, world, self, etc. goes away. We become incredibly focused, so much so that we become un-self-conscious. We get lost in the experience itself.

2) *Control of Focus.* Next we meta-state the focus with *control*, control of the focus. This precisely fits the NLP objective of "running our own brain" and the Meta-States' objective of managing the higher levels of mind. This enables us to turn the focus state on and off at will. If we can't do this, then the demon has the genius. This generates the gestalt that we call self-management, self-discipline, etc. We are then able to take responsibility *for* self and *to* others, to establish collaborations with others and develop a good relationship to social, neurological, and psychological constraints.

3) *Flexibility of Consciousness.* We texture the flow state of genius with the ability to take numerous perceptual positions (first, second, third, third-reverse, etc.). This creates a mental and emotional flexibility, a flexibility that allows us to adapt, change, and adjust to circumstances and it is this that keeps our genius or demon fluid and under our control rather than rigid and locked in. This endows our mind-emotion system with a richness of awareness.

4) *Creative.* This refers to our ability to mix and merge different things, to sort and integrate differences. The mind of a genius does not sort for similarity as much as for differences. And it lies in differences, in the unusual, strange, unthought of connections that invites the new ideas, processes, inventions, etc. This bi-lateral thinking makes for lots of false starts in the creativity.
5) *Playfully passionate learning.* A learning that first of all informs us about the state of art in a field, its language, symbols, principles, models, etc. Yet it keeps us curious, playful, open, always learning, always exploring. It thrills in possibility thinking that explores new "what ifs..."

6) *Firmness of a clear vision*. The larger passion serves the genius as the meta-frame from which to operate and the self-organizing attractor. This is the believing in something, the mental strength to see the passionate vision to completion, through dedication, perseverance, discipline, efficiency, etc. This is the *intentional stance* of the genius that governs the meta-detailing. It provides us a clarity of outcome all the way up the levels to give shape to our sense of mission and purpose.

7) *Proactively active.* We texture our genius focus state with the ability to take action, to develop effective and efficient work habits, to be self-initiating, self-referencing, to be able to inspire oneself with one's vision. Implied within this is a good relationship to failure, mistakes, errors, problems, and challenges. The genius truly feels that such is just exploring, experimenting, finding out what doesn't work, information gathering, feedback. And this leads to the personal power of implementing and following-through.

8) *Congruently aligned in the focus.* Finally there is a texturing of the focus state with an alignment at all of the higher logical levels which generates a congruency.
9) *Socially connected.* Geniuses work in a field and so with others as collaborators, colleagues, etc.

10) *Meta-Detailing.* A clear vision of purpose and objective *and* the proactive power to follow-through, we access the genius characteristic of being able to detail out the our meta-frame of mind. This leads to a powerful efficiency so that we carry out the critical and vital details essential to our vision without getting "caught up in details."

All of this saves us from the opposite states of mind and emotion that sabotage and undermine personal genius. Namely:

Apathetic, uncaring, unmotivated
Unfocused, Distracted
Negative and pessimistic in thinking and feeling
Fear of failure, hesitant
Inertia, procrastinating, passive
Alone, unsupported
Overly individualistic

"A Personal genius! Who me?"
Yes, definitely! Your passions and visions in life, plus your unique aptitudes and interests, as well as your unique combination of intelligences combine together to provide you the basis for *excellence* and *expertise* in your life. If that sounds too complex, then you'll love to know that using the state-of-the-art models, patterns, and technologies in NLP and Neuro-Semantics, you'll be able to access

your personal genius one piece at a time and layer one component upon another until the larger configuration emerges from your systemic consciousness.

THE TEXTURING OF STATES

Becoming a "State" Connoisseur

- Suppose you could *texture* your mental and emotional states...
- Suppose you could add various *tastes, feels, qualities* to your current frame of mind...
- Suppose you could make the way you move through the world *richer and fuller* and radiating with a delightful and fascinating *aroma*...
- Suppose that you're not stuck or limited with just the plain vanilla states...

If we begin with, and use, these *supposing* questions regarding the quality and nature of our everyday mind-body states, we can then begin to *design* and *engineer* the very quality of our lives. When we do this, we move to one of the most exciting and captivating features of *Meta-States.*

Plain Vanilla States

Consider the nature and quality of some of the following mental and emotional states. Examine the following list of terms that summarize these common everyday states and take a moment to explore them in terms of how you experience the *quality* of these states. You could ask about their —

- Intensity and Strength
- Accessibility and Development
- Features and Feel
- Ecology and Balance

Confidence	Anger	Joy
Clarity	Fear	Playfulness
Commitment	Anxiety	Respect
Courage	Sadness	Interest
Congruence	Discouragement	Enthusiasm
Curiosity	Tension	Relaxation

What kind of *texture* do you experience with these states? What are some of the qualities and properties that characterize them? Perhaps you experience —

Hesitating confidence; courageous confidence; foolish confidence; playful confidence, bold confidence

Slow Clarity; dull clarity; bright and brilliant clarity, developing clarity, curious clarity.

Fear of commitment; total commitment; stressful commitment, playful commitment, miserable commitment.

Aggressive curiosity, rigid curiosity, humorous and silly curiosity, serious curiosity.

Hostile anger; dreadful fear of anger; shame about feeling guilty for being angry

Shameful fear; bold fear; curious fear; playful fear

The Meta-State Flush Out

The fact that we have and experience our mind-body states in terms of other qualities and properties informs us that we have, and carry with us, *meta-states*. Typically, however, we don't experience them as "meta." It all seems part and parcel of one state—one experience. This only means that the higher level thoughts and feelings that we have applied or "brought to bear" upon the plain vanilla state has completely coalesced into the state and now comprises it's texture.

In this way, our meta-states get "into our eyes." They coalesce and percolate into our muscles. Of course, when this happens, we cease to notice them as separate or a part of our regular everyday states. They become *a part of* the state and no longer *apart.* They enter into the state as the higher level qualifying and governing frames-of-reference. And in this way, our meta-states seem hidden and invisible to us even though we never leave home without them.

Yet we can easily tease out the higher levels. We can use the qualities of our states as a way to *flush out meta-states* (whether your own or those of someone else). Simple inquire about the quality of a state.

> Say, when you get angry, what's the quality of your anger?
> Would I like you angry?
> Are you respectful and thoughtful when you're angry?
> Or do you lose your head and go ballistic when you get mad?
> Can you maintain civility and patience when you're feeling upset and angry?
> Or do you become impatient and insulting?

The answers and responses that emerge from the *quality question* about a state *flushes out* the higher frames. And typically, there are many of them. You can also ask about other meta-level phenomena.

> What do you believe about anger?
> What memories in your personal history informs you about this?
> What values or dis-values do you have about experiencing anger?
> What moral judgments do you make about this?
> How does this affect who you are?
> How does anger play into or fail to play into your destiny, mission, and vision?
> What do you expect about anger? About people when they get angry?

Understanding the Meta-Levels in our States

Far from exhausting the subject, these questions just get us started in this domain of the meta-levels in our Neuro-Semantics. Yet to fully understand what we mean by meta-states and their importance, we need to step back and think about our everyday states. At first reckoning, they seem ordinary, plain, and of vanilla flavoring. But they are not.

They are textured. They have properties and features and characteristics that go far beyond "plain vanilla." Over the years, via everyday experiences, we come to *qualify them*. We set them inside of various frames-of-reference. And every time we do, we thereby create a meta-level state. And remember, we're using the term "state" here as a holistic and dynamic term that includes state of mind, state of body, and state of emotion.

So, using "anger" as a prototype, we come to experience *thoughts-and-feelings and neurological somatic sensations* **about** the state of anger. We like it or dislike it. We fear it or love it. We dread it or long for it. We believe it can serve us; we believe it only turns things ugly. All of these are meta-states. *Dynamic, ever-moving and changing mental and emotional states* **about** other states.

Structurally, a meta-state stands in special relationship to our states. They relate to the primary state as a higher state of awareness *about* it. This makes them *about* the lower state as a classification of it. The junior state functions as a member of that class. The higher or meta-state functions as a category for understanding and feeling *about* the lower.

> That's why "fear of our anger" (fearful anger) differs in texture so much from "respect of our anger" (respectful anger).
> That's why "shame about getting angry because it only turns things nasty" differs so much in texture to "appreciation of my powers to get angry because it informs me that some perceived

value or understanding feels violated and allows me to respectfully explore the situation *anger."*

As a higher logical level, the mental and emotional *frames* that we bring to our primary experiences represent *the governing influence* in our lives. The higher frame as a message about the lower experiences modulates, organizes, and governs. It functions like a self-organizing attractor in the mind-body system. That's why meta-states are so important. In your meta-states, you will find all of your values, beliefs, expectations, understandings, identifications, etc.

The Systemic Nature of Meta-States

While I have teased apart the structure of our higher frames-of-references (or meta-states) from the primary experiences, we can only do that for sake of analysis and understanding. In actual practice primary and meta levels of experiences or states merge into *one unit.* Research scientist Arthur Koestler introduced the term "holons" many years ago to describe reality as composed of *"whole/parts."* These whole/parts *holons* refer to any "entity" that is itself *a whole* and yet simultaneously *a part* of some other whole.

Consider our "states" as holons. We experience our "states" as a whole. Confidence, courage, commitment, playfulness, joy, flow, etc. We experience each as a whole within itself. And yet, they also all exist (and actually *only* exist as a part of some larger whole). We would have no state without a body, a functioning nervous system, a thinking brain, "life," oxygen, an atmosphere, etc.

A mind-body state operates as a holon also in terms of all of the higher mental and emotional frames (beliefs, values, expectations, etc.) that support it. The state of confidence is *a whole* and it is also *a part* of many other higher level frames.

Ken Wilber speaks about holons in terms of *agency and communion, and transcendence and dissolution. Each holon has its own identity or autonomy.* It has its own agency or identity as a whole. Yet as a *holon* within a larger whole, it also communicates and has communion with other wholes (i.e., confidence with respect, within esteem for self, within possibilities, etc.). This allows it to *transcend* itself and to go beyond what it has been to become more of what it can be. It can add novel components to itself. Or it can dissolve. A holon can be pulled up or pulled down.

Yet when a state as a holon moves up and experiences a transcendent of itself (self-transcendence) something new *emerges.* This occurs, for example, when we develop a compelling outcome so that we're empowered to boldly face a fear. In this case, *courage* emerges. And while the lower was transcended and included in the higher, this continuous process produces discontinuities. Yet the *leap* upward does not work in reverse.

In systems theory, we say that the new *gestalt* is "more than the sum of the parts." Some new configuration has *emerged.* And merely *adding* all of the parts together does not, and cannot, explain it. *Emergence* has occurred. There was a leap upward to a higher form of organization and structure. Wilber (1996) writes:

> "So there are both discontinuties in evolution —mind cannot be reduced to life, and life cannot be reduced to matter; and there are continuities .." (p. 24)

He also says that "holons emerge holarchically." (p. 27) . This term, holarchically, also comes from Koestler and replaces "hierarchy." Holarchically describes what we mean by a natural hierarchy, not the ones that we create which involve dominations. Natural hierarchies describe an order of increasing wholeness: particles to atoms to cells to organisms or letters to words to sentences to paragraphs. The whole of one level becomes a part of the whole of the next.

Each higher level *embraces* and *engulfs* the lower. That's why when we take a primary everyday state like anger or confidence and set various frames on it, we create new emergent properties to nurture the mind-and-body on.

> Imagine embracing your anger with acceptance, appreciation, and then wonder. Imagine engulfing it in love, respect, and honor. Imagine applying mindfulness, values, and patience to it. Imagine bringing ecology concerns, moral uprightness, and honor to it. Mix well. Put into the oven of your mind, let it bake for awhile...
> Imagine embracing your power to take action in the world with acceptance and appreciation. Imagine engulfing it with ownership, excitement, and joy. Imagine applying hope, desired outcomes, willingness to take intelligent risks, love, and concern for others, to it. Mix all of these well in a state of contemplative relaxation. Let it bake as you learn and explore and develop...

Texturing occurs. With *Meta-States*, you can now take charge of the process and design the kind of quality states that will turn you on to life in new and exciting ways.

***States Plus:* Transcend and Include**

To transcend any everyday plain vanilla state, we begin at the primary level of consciousness as we notice our thoughts and feelings *about* something "out there" in the world. This defines a primary state. Our awareness focuses on something external to ourselves. We fear driving fast, closed in places, particular tones of voices. We get angry at violence, insults, and threats to our way of life. We delight in and enjoy the beauty of a scene or a piece of music.

We *transcend* this experience while *including it* as we move up to a higher level of thought, emotion, and awareness. This creates a new level of organization. We have something *higher* that still contains the essentials of the lower *plus something else.*

> In respect, considerate, and patient anger —we still have anger. We still have the sense of threat or danger to our person or way of life, yet the *anger* is now textured in larger levels of mind and emotion. That causes something new to emerge. We have the Anger State *Plus* something that transcends "mere" anger (that is, animal-like, brute anger). Now we have a higher kind of *human* anger, even spiritual anger.

We have hierarchy (levels) of states or holoarchy because as Aristotle first pointed out:

> All of the lower is in the higher, but not all of the higher is in the lower.

Molecules contain atoms, but atoms do not contain molecules. As we move up levels, the higher level *includes* the lower and *transcends* it. As it transcends the lower, it *adds* new features, qualities, properties, and characteristics to it. In Meta-States this provides us the ability to engineer new emergent properties for our states. It gives us the key to the structure of subjectivity as experiences become more complex and layered.

> When our learning is *taken up into* playfulness and appreciation, when we *engulf* it with passion and the intention to improve the quality of life—something new emerges. We have a passionate learning state that's much accelerated and that's a real turn-on. It takes on more of the qualities of "genius." Each higher level has added new components that enrich the emergent gestalt. Now something bigger and more expansive arises. Now we have the Learning State *Plus*.

Meta-State Permeation

When I first wrote the text for *Meta-States* (1995), I made numerous mistakes in conceptualizing and theorizing about the structure of the model. These have been completely updated and the mistakes eliminated in the totally revised edition (2000). One of those mistakes involved thinking that the higher levels could not be anchored kinesthetically. At the time I didn't understand how the higher

levels operate as holons, how they not only *transcend* but also *embrace and include* the lower levels. I now understand how they *permeate* the lower levels giving what had been a plain vanilla state all kinds of rich textures, tastes, aromas, etc.

Accordingly, we have recently been developing a whole series of patterns and processes for "mind-muscling" the mind-body integration that fully allows the higher levels to percolate down through the levels. This completes the process by which we layer thought upon thought and feeling upon feeling so that in the end we have holons— whole/part states within a hierarchal or holarchical systems. These **State Plus** experiences then offer us top-notch high quality states that we have textured with the very best of resources. And when you get to this place, you have entered into the highest of design engineering with Meta-States. Now we have a powerful process for texturing our states so that they respond to our intentional designs.

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MORE ON "LOGICAL LEVELS"

Robert Dilts:

"In our brain structure, language, and perceptual systems there are natural *hierarchies* or levels of experiences. The effect of each level is to *organize and control the information on the level below it*. Changing something on an upper level would necessarily change things on the lower levels; changing something on a lower level could but would not necessarily affect the upper levels." (Dilts, Epstein, Dilts, 1991, p. 26, *italics* added).

"Logical Levels: an internal hierarchy in which each level is progressively more psychologically *encompassing and impactful*" (1990: 217, *italics* added).

Gregory Bateson:

A Logical Type: 1) The name is not the thing named but is of different logical type, higher than the thing named. 2) The class is of different logical type, higher than that of its members. (Mary Catherine Bateson, 1987, pp. 209-210).

Criteria for "logical levels:"

1. *Hierarchies* of experience.
2. Higher levels *organize and control* information on lower levels.
3. The *modulation* effect of the system necessarily works downward.
4. The modulation effect of the system does not necessarily work upward.
5. Higher levels operate more *encompassing and impactful* than the lower levels.
6. There exists a *discontinuity* between the levels—a break.
7. The relationship of logic between levels creates "paradox" if we don't sort phenomena on different levels.
8. Hierarchical logical levels function as a *system*, the higher levels arise *out of* the lower and *feed back* information into the system to influence the lower levels. This creates recursiveness within logical levels.

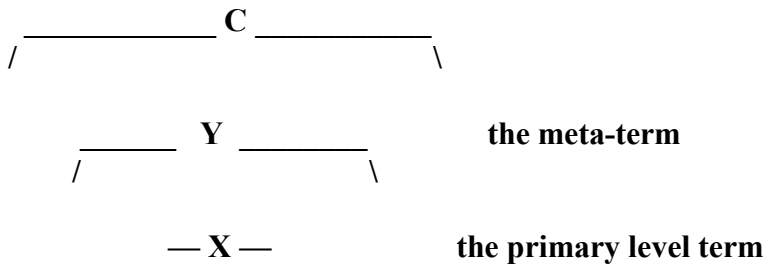
9. As a cybernetic system, as information moves up logical levels *new features emerge* that does not exist at the lower levels. This emergence at higher levels involve, in systems language, summitivity. In other words, the emergent property does not exist only as the sum of the parts, but new properties and qualities arise over "time" within the system.
10. *Reflexivity* describes one of the new features that emerge in logical levels. In living organisms this results in self-reflexiveness or self-consciousness.
11. As a system with feedback properties, logical levels operates by self-reflexiveness, the whole system becomes cybernetic. It becomes a "system that feeds back onto and changes itself" (Dilts, 1990, 33). This makes it self-organizing.

THE META-LEVEL STRUCTURE OF CULTURE

By meta-stating we can construct social realities and work with cultural phenomenon.

John Searle (*The Construction of Social Reality, 1995)* created a model for thinking about and working how cultures (groups of people) and cultural phenomena. Using his formula, we can now methodically work to construct higher level realities. This enables us to *model social realities* using Meta-States:

X counts as Y in C



Here **Y** operates as a meta-term in a given **C** (Context) to thereby enable us to categorize and construct social realities from various brute empirical facts of the world (**X**).

Money: Paper printed as denominations of money (**X**) *counts as* **Y** ("money") in the **C**ontext of a given culture.
Points and Games: Running across a line on a field (X) *counts as* "making points" (Y) in a football Game ©.

In this way we can do much more than merely make meaning, appraise meanings, we can:

Assign Status and Roles
Assign Functions: performance and operations (Speech acts)
Assign Status-Functions (obligations, responsibilities, privileges)

The Structural Differential:

Korzybski's (1933 *Science and Sanity*) levels of abstraction is a model that describes how we *abstract* or summarize from the world energy manifestations "out there." We bring these in via our sense receptors, abstract again and process (in specialized parts of our cortex) as sensory representations. We again abstract as we say sensory-based words about such—about which we then abstract and say evaluative-based words, about which we can abstract again & say more evaluative-based words, etc.

	Etc.	— *Beyond Words*
	↑↓	
	Evaluative words	
	↑↓	
Linguistic	Evaluative Words — Third Order	
maps	↑↓	
of ↓	Evaluative words — Concepts: Second Order Abstractions	
	↑↓	
	Sensory-Based Words	
	(A_d)	
	↑↓	
Neurological	Sensory Representations	— Biological Phenomena
maps	(V.A.K.O.G.)	
of ↓	↑↓	
	Sense Receptors	
	↑↓	
		Before Words
External Reality	"Reality" Beyond the Nervous System	

***Gregory Bateson**:*

Taking the thread of "learning," Bateson wove the following "Logical Levels of Learning" model. These orders of learning give us a true logical level system because the higher levels drive the lower levels and each higher level operates as a category or classification of the class members in the lower level.

Learning IV:	Learning to Alter the Processes Involved in Learning III
	@ ↓
Learning III:	Learning to Learn
	@ ↓
Learning II: Deutro-Learning	Learning
	@ ↓
Learning I: Or Proto-Learning:	Reception of a Signal Learning New Response
Zero Learning	No Response to a Signal

MODEL THIS TRAINING IS BASED UPON

NLP — Neuro-Linguistic Programming

- A communication model about how we process information within ourselves and to others. It enables us to *run our own brain* by using the languages of the mind, the languages that we use to create our cinemas that we play out on the theater of our mind. These are the sights (visual), sounds (auditory) and sensations (kinesthetics), smells (olfactory) and tastes (gustatory) senses. We make sense of things with our internal senses. We internally process information and represent it in our MovieMind. NLP was developed by a linguistic and computer student about human excellence to provide step-by-step processes (patterns) for running our own brain.
- State management. How we process induces us into mind-body-emotion states, neuro-linguistic states. Our States are critically important: The quality of our life is the quality of our states.
- Modeling: As a model, NLP explores human excellence—people at their best and what's possible rather than how people are broken.
- Mind-Body system: The linguistics of NLP begin with the sensory "languages" of the mind and then moves to the meta-representation system that we call language. The neurology refers to our nervous system and physiology—where our states find everyday expression in our behaviors and emotions.
- *Origins:* NLP, the study of *the structure of subjective experience,* began as a search to understand how superior language skills create therapeutic magic. Though but a college student studying computer programming and mathematics, Richard Bandler had a gift for mimicking. As he listened to audio-tapes by Fritz Perls, Richard found himself mimicking him and later reproducing much of the magic of Gestalt Therapy without having studied it. It happened also in recording Virginia Satir. How could that happen? Enter Dr. John Grinder. As a linguist and young scholar in the field of Transformational Grammar, John applied his analytical skills to break down the magic in the language. Together they discovered and formulated *The Structure of Magic.* In *Modeling Excellence*, NLP explores the structuring of our empowering and enhancing states as well as the limiting and pathological ones in order to specify the *Programming* that we create via our mapping. And so the magic begins.

META-STATES®

- A state about another state as in joyful about learning, playful about being serious, curious about anger, calm about fear. The thoughts-and-feelings about other thoughts-and-feelings as mind reflects back onto itself and its products.

Kinds of States:

- *Primary states* are primary emotions like fear, anger, joy, relaxed, tense, pleasure, pain, etc. and involve thoughts directed outward to the things "out there."
- *Meta-states* are higher level structures like fear of fear, anger at fear, shame about being embarrassed, esteem of self, etc. In these states, our self-reflexivity relates (not to the world), but to ourselves, to our thoughts, feelings, or to some abstract conceptual state.
- *Gestalt states* are emergent properties from layering or laminating mind repeatedly with other states. It gives rise to a new neuro-semantic *system*, an emergent state that's "more than the sum of the parts" such as courage, self-efficacy, resilience, and seeing opportunities.

Meta-State Distinctions:

- *Frames:* As a model Meta-States describes our higher *frames-of-references*. We set these up and use them to create stable structures (i.e., beliefs, values, understandings, etc.). We develop these frames which we can keep with us.
- *Reflexivity:* We ever just think. As soon as we think or feel—we then experience thoughts and feelings *about* that first thought, then other thoughts-and-feelings about that thought, and so on. Our self-reflective consciousness works as an "infinite regress" to recursively iterate.
- *Layering:* In meta-states we layer states onto states to create higher levels of awareness. In layering thinking-and-feeling, we put one state in a higher or *meta* (above, beyond) position to the second. This creates a "*logical type" or "logical level*."
- *Psycho-Logics:* A special kind of internal logic arises from layering of states. When we *transcend* from one state (say, anger or joy) to another state (say, calmness or respect) we set the second state as a

frame over the first and *include* it inside it. This gives us "calm anger," respectful joy, joyful learning, etc. It makes the first state a member of the class of the second.

- *Non-Linear:* It's not logical in a linear or external way, yet it is *psycho–logical.* Internally when we put a state like anger or fear inside another state (calmness, respect, gentleness, courage, etc.), we change the internal logic of our nervous system and person. This is what we mean when we talk about "logical levels." When we put one state in a "logical" relationship to another state so that one is at a higher *level* then the higher one is *about* the other. This *about-relationship* establishes the "logic."
- *Self-Organizing:* There are no such "things" as logical levels. They do not exist "out there." But only in the mind as how we represent categories and levels. With this logical typing or leveling, the effect of each level is to *organize and control the information on the level below it*. In logical levels each level is progressively more psychologically encompassing and impactful.
- *Coalescing:* By *repetition and habituation* higher frames or states *coalesce* into the lower states. The higher thoughts-and-feelings soak down into them to *qualify* or texture the lower state.

NEURO-SEMANTICS® —

- The *meanings* (semantics) that we have in our minds by means of our words, language, memory, and imagination does not just stay in our heads, it gets into our bodies. Our neurology translates the *meanings* in our minds into *feelings* in our bodies (neurology) so that we then experience neuro-semantic states.
- Neuro-Semantics is the scientific term for the mind-body connection. It involves a *working model* of the translation of mental *meaning* into physiological responses (emotions, behaviors, reactions). Neuro-Semantics also includes hundreds of processes or patterns that allow us to strategically and methodically work with mind to create the best states of body and health that's possible.

Neuro-Semantic Distinctions:

- *Emotions:* When something *means* something to us—we *feel* it in our bodies. The meanings show up as "emotions." The meanings take the form of values, ideas, beliefs, understandings, paradigms, mental models, frames, etc.
- *Meaning-Making:* Neuro-Semantics is a model of how we make meaning through evaluating experiences, events, words, etc. It's a model of how we then live in the World or Matrix of Meaning that we construct and inherit.
- *Matrix as Frames of Meaning:* Neuro-Semantics describes the frames of reference we use as we move through life and the frames of meaning that we construct. It creates the Matrix of Frames in which we live and from which we operate.
- *Semantic Reactions:* The reactions that occur which indicate our semantic structures.
- *Generative Neuro-Semantics:* Building up new gestalt states which offer new experiences which are more than the sum of the parts.
- *Systemic:* The meta-state structure of Neuro-Semantics involves a different kind of thinking as it shifts from linear to non-linear thinking. Systemic thinking involves *reflexivity, recursiveness, and spiral thinking.* It means following feedback and feed forward loops around the loops of the fluid Matrix Frames.

Neuro-Semantic Models:

There are now several specific *Neuro-Semantic models.* These include the following:

- The *Meta-States model* that maps our reflexivity and describes our layering of states upon states.
- The *Mind-Lines model* for conversational reframing for communication skills, influence, and leadership.
- The *Frame Games or Inner Game model* for diagnosing, understanding, and working with states and behaviors as "games" driven and modulated by "frames." From the inner game of our frames to the outer games of actual performance and competence.
- The *Matrix Model* that specifies seven matrices as a diagnostic and modeling tool.
- The *Axes of Change* model that maps the process of change and transformation and how a manager or coach can work effectively and strategically as a Change Agent.
- The *Self-Actualization Quadrants* of meaning and performance.
- The *Peak Performance Model* for taking performance to the highest levels.

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L. Michael Hall is a psychologist who is continuing the modeling of self-actualization that Abraham Maslow began. Beginning with his work in Cognitive psychology, he discovered the field of NLP and worked for awhile with Richard Bandler, the genius behind the NLP model. Then modeling resilience he discovered the Meta-States model that because the most significant contribution to NLP in the 1990s. That led to the creation of the field of Neuro-Semantics and later, with Bob Bodenhamer, the creation of the *International Society of Neuro-Semantics.* Since the early 1990s, he has modeled leadership, learning, selling, wealth creation, and then coaching. That led to the founding of the Meta-Coach Training System with Michelle Duval. When he began modeling Self-Actualization Psychology for Meta-Coaching, that led to the Self-Actualization Quadrants and other models.

Today Michael is a visionary leader in the field of Neuro-Semantics and Self-Actualization Psychology. He works as an entrepreneur, researcher/modeler, and international trainer. His doctorate is in the Cognitive-Behavioral sciences from Union Institute University. He had a therapy practice in Colorado for fifteen years. Then he found NLP (1986) and wrote several books for Richard Bandler. As a prolific writer, Michael has written more than 50 books, many best sellers in the field of NLP and today has written more books about NLP than anyone in the field. Michael first applied NLP to coaching in 1991, but didn't create the beginnings of Neuro-Semantic Coaching until 2001 when together with Michelle Duval co-created Meta-Coaching trainings. In 2003, the Meta-Coach Foundation was create.

Books by L. Michael Hall, Ph.D.

NLP and Neuro-Semantics:
1) *Meta-States: Mastering the Higher Levels of Mind* (1995/ 2012).
2) *Dragon Slaying: Dragons to Princes* (1996 / 2000).
3) *The Spirit of NLP: The Process, Meaning and Criteria for Mastering NLP* (1996).
4) *Languaging: The Linguistics of Psychotherapy* (1996, spiral).
5) *Becoming More Ferocious as a Presenter* (1996, spiral book).
6) *Patterns For Renewing the Mind* (with Bodenhamer, 1997 /2006).
7) *Time-Lining: Advance Time-Line Processes* (with Bodenhamer, 1997).
8) *NLP: Going Meta—Advance Modeling Using Meta-Levels* (1997/ 2001).
9) *Figuring Out People: Reading People Using Meta-Programs* (with Bodenhamer, 1997, 2005).
10) *SourceBook of Magic, Volume I* (with Barbara Belnap, 1997).

11) *Mind-Lines: Lines For Changing Minds* (with Bodenhamer, 1997/ 2005).
12) *Communication Magic* (2001). Originally, *The Secrets of Magic* (1998). Recent update: *The New Meta-Model* (2021).
13) *Meta-State Magic: Meta-State Journal* (1997-1999).
14) *Sub-Modalities Go Meta* (with Bodenhamer, 1999, 2005). Originally, *The Structure of Excellence.*
15) *Instant Relaxation* (with Lederer, 1999).
16) *The User's Manual for the Brain: Volume I* (with Bodenhamer, 1999).
17) *The Structure of Personality:* Modeling Personality Using NLP and Neuro-Semantics (with Bodenhamer, Bolstad, and Harmblett, 2001).
18) *The Secrets of Personal Mastery* (2000).
19) *Winning the Inner Game* (2007), originally *Frame Games* (2000).
20) *Games Fit and Slim People Play* (2001).

21) *Games for Mastering Fear* (with Bodenhamer, 2001).
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23) *The Matrix Model: Neuro-Semantics and the Construction of Meaning* (2003/2016).
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25) *MovieMind*: *Directing Your Mental Cinemas* (2002).
26) *The Bateson Report* (2002).
27) *Make it So! Closing the Knowing-Doing Gap* (2002). (Out of Print)
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29) *Propulsion Systems* (2003).
30) *Games Great Lovers Play* (2004).

31) *Coaching Conversation, Meta-Coaching, Volume II* (with Michelle Duval & Robert Dilts 2004, 2010).
32) *Coaching Change, Meta-Coaching, Volume I* (with Duval, 2004/ 2015).
33) *Unleashed: The Ultimate Self-Actualization* (2007 Vol. III).
34) *Self-Actualization Psychology* (2008, Volume IV).
35) *Achieving Peak Performance* (2009, Volume V).
36) *Unleashing Leadership: Self-Actualizing Leaders and Companies* (2009, Vol VI).
37) *The Crucible and the Fires of Change* (2010, Volume VII).
38) *Inside-Out Wealth* (2010).
39) *Benchmarking: The Art of Measuring the Unqualifiable* (2011, Volume VIII).
40) *Innovations in NLP: Volume I* (Edited with Shelle Rose Charvet; 2011).

41) *Neuro-Semantics: Actualizing Meaning and Performance* (2011)
42) *Systemic Coaching: Coaching the Whole Person with Meta-Coaching* (with Pascal Gambardella, Ph.D., 2012, Volume IX).
43) *Group and Team Coaching* (2013, Volume X).
44) *Executive Coaching: Facilitating Excellence in the C-Suite* (2014, Volume XI).
45) *Political Coaching: Unleashing Self-Actualizing Politicians.* (2015, Volume XII).
46) *Collaborative Leadership,* with Ian McDermott. (2016).
47) *The Field of NLP* with John Seymour and Richard Gray (unfinished).
48) *The Meta-Coaching System* (2015, Volume XIII).
49) *Get Real: Unleashing Authenticity* (2016, Volume XIV).
50) *Inside-Out Persuasion* (2017, Volume XV).

51) *Creative Solutions* (2017, Volume XVI).
52) *Executive Thinking: Activating Your Highest Executive Thinking Potentials* (2018).
53) *NLP Secrets: Untold Stories* (2019).
54) *Thinking as a Modeler* (2019).
55) *Thinking Hypnotically*(2020).
56) *Hypnotic Conversations for Unleashing Potentials* (2020)
57) *Humorous Thinking* (2020)
58) *Resilience: Being the Phoenix* (2020)
59) *Executive Decisions: Deciding Wisely* (2020)
60) *Thinking Metaphorically: Become a Metaphorian* (2021)

61) *Executive Learning: Learning How to Learn* (2021)
62) *Executive Wisdom:* Being One of the Wise Ones (2022)
63) *Inside Out: Empowered from Within* (2022).

Serial Books
Books written in weekly installments to the Neuro-Semantic community (Neurons), to the Meta-Coaches egroup (Morpheus), to the Neuro-Semantic Trainers egroup (Framers). These are now PDF books on the Neuro-Semantic website. At the end of 2021, 39 volumes.

Neurons began as the Meta-Reflections in 2008 and each year consists of another book. As of 2021 — 14 volumes.
Morpheus began as the Meta-Coach Reflections in 2009. As of 2021, 13 volumes.
Framers is the Trainers' Reflections which began in 2010. As of 2021 12 volumes.

Other books:
1) *Emotions: Sometimes I Have Them/ Sometimes They have Me* (1985)
2) *Motivation: How to be a Positive Influence in a Negative World* (1987)
3) *Speak Up, Speak Clear, Speak Kind* (1987)
4) *Millennial Madness* (1992), now *Apocalypse Then, Not Now* (1996).
5) *Over My Dead Body* (1996).

Order Books from: **NSP: Neuro-Semantic Publications**
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Neuro-Semantics as an Association

In 1996 Hall and Bodenhamer registered "Neuro-Semantics" and founded *The International Society of Neuro-Semantics* (ISNS) as a new approach to teaching, training, and using NLP. The objective was to take NLP, as a model and field, to a higher level in terms of professional ethics and quality. Today Neuro-Semantics is one of the leading disciplines and movements within NLP as it is pioneering many new developments and demonstrating a fresh creativity similar to what characterized NLP when it was new.

Dr. Hall is known as a prolific writer, having authored 60 books in the field of NLP, many of them best sellers through *Crown House Publications* (Wales, UK) and many of them translated into numerous languages: German, Dutch, Italian, Spanish, Russian, Japanese, Chinese, Arabic, Norwegian, Portuguese, etc. www.neurosemantics.com

The Meta-Coaching System

As a complete and comprehensive coaching system, the *Meta-Coaching System* began in 2001 when L. Michael Hall, Ph.D. modeled four expert coaches. He then applied the Neuro-Linguistic Programming (NLP) and Neuro-Semantic models to the burgeoning field of Coaching. As a systemic model, the Meta-Coaching System enables a professional Coach to answer the question: *How do you know what to do, when to do it, with whom to do it, how to do what you're doing, and why?*

When you can think strategically as a Coach, you will be able to recognize where you are with a client and what to do. Having a theoretical model that answers the *why are you doing that?* question saves your coaching from being a grab-bag of tricks so you don't have to coach-by-the-seat-of-your-pants.

To meet this rigorous criteria, the Meta-Coaching System is based on eight models— models which are based in Cognitive-Behavioral, Developmental, and Self-Actualization psychologies. The design is to give Meta-Coaching a credible scientific basis. Then as a coach you will not fall back on what you "feel like" on a certain day, your "intuitions" (which may be your own unresolved issues), or some trick that you have picked up on a weekend training.

Today Meta-Coaching standards are the highest in the field of Coaching as it offers specific behavioral benchmarks for every one of the 50 coaching skills. It also has developed a Benchmarking Intangibles Model for how to generate rigorous benchmarks for any value or skill. The Meta-Coaching System also has an accountability structure to the ethics and standards which governs every

licenced Meta-Coach. There are now 16 books detailing the curriculum of Meta-Coaching, and several more in the works. The Meta-Coaching System is inclusive of other systems as Meta-Coaches around the world in 70 countries are often on the board of ICF and many other Coach training programs. Trainings in Meta-Coaching occur every year dozens of times in every continent.

Meta-Coaching Series

In the field of Coaching, *the Meta-Coaching System* is a leading model in framing the process of effective coaching in a highly systematic way. The design is to provide a Professional Coach with the ability to know *what* to do, *when* to do it, *how* to do it, with whom to do it, and *why* to do it. The design also is to establish the field of coaching in the unique psychology for psychologically healthy people who want to change and develop, namely, *Self-Actualization Psychology*. To achieve that Dr. Hall has committed to writing the models and processes in a series of books that comprise the curriculum of Meta-Coaching.

Meta-Coaching Series

Volume	Title	Model
I:	Coaching Change	Axes of Change Model
II:	Coaching Conversations	Facilitation Model
III:	Unleashed: Self-Actualization	Self-Actualization Quadrants
IV:	Self-Actualization Psychology	Self-Actualization Volcano
V:	Achieving Peak Performance	Meaning–Performance Axes
VI:	Unleashing Leadership: Self-Actualizing Leaders & Companies	Axes of Leadership
VII:	The Crucible	The Crucible Model
VIII:	Benchmarking Intangibles	Benchmarking Model
IX:	Systemic Meta-Coaching	The Matrix Model
X:	Group & Team Meta-Coaching	Group Trust Spiral
XI:	Executive Coaching	
XII:	Political Coaching	
XIII:	The Meta-Coaching System	
XIV:	Get Real: Unleashing Authenticity	
XV:	Inside-Out Persuasion	
XVI:	Creative Solutions	The Neuro-Semantic Precision Funnel

Meta-Coaching also based on the following Books:

Figuring Out People (2006)	The Meta-Programs Model
Secrets of Personal Mastery (1997)	The Meta-States Model
Winning the Inner Game (2007)	The Meta-States Model
The Matrix Model (2003)	Neuro-Semantic Systems Model
Communication Magic (1999)	The Meta-Model of Language